

A decorative border with intricate floral and scrollwork patterns in a dark green color, framing the central text.

BibInVs MN 06

Joshua

*Bible Translation:
Interverse MSG/NIV - 6*

God

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Interversed Message/NIV Bible

Joshua

Joshua 1

MSG

NIV

- 1 After the death of Moses the servant of GOD, GOD spoke to Joshua, Moses' assistant:
- 1 After the death of Moses the servant of the LORD, the LORD said to Joshua son of Nun, Moses' aide:
 - 2 "Moses my servant is dead. Get going. Cross this Jordan River, you and all the people. Cross to the country I'm giving to the People of Israel.
 - 2 Moses my servant is dead. Now then, you and all these people, get ready to cross the Jordan River into the land I am about to give to them--to the Israelites.
 - 3 I'm giving you every square inch of the land you set your foot on--just as I promised Moses.
 - 3 I will give you every place where you set your foot, as I promised Moses.
 - 4 From the wilderness and this Lebanon east to the Great River, the Euphrates River--all the Hittite country--and then west to the Great Sea. It's all yours.
 - 4 Your territory will extend from the desert to Lebanon, and from the great river, the Euphrates--all the Hittite country--to the Great Sea on the west.
 - 5 All your life, no one will be able to hold out against you. In the same way I was with Moses, I'll be with you. I won't give up on you; I won't leave you.
 - 5 No one will be able to stand up against you all the days of your life. As I was with Moses, so I will be with you; I will never leave you nor forsake you.
 - 6 Strength! Courage! You are going to lead this people to inherit the land that I promised to give their ancestors.
 - 6 Be strong and courageous, because you will lead these people to inherit the land I swore to their forefathers to give them.

- 7 Give it everything you have, heart and soul. Make sure you carry out The Revelation that Moses commanded you, every bit of it. Don't get off track, either left or right, so as to make sure you get to where you're going.
- 7 Be strong and very courageous. Be careful to obey all the law my servant Moses gave you; do not turn from it to the right or to the left, that you may be successful wherever you go.
- 8 And don't for a minute let this Book of The Revelation be out of mind. Ponder and meditate on it day and night, making sure you practice everything written in it. Then you'll get where you're going; then you'll succeed.
- 8 Do not let this Book of the Law depart from your mouth; meditate on it day and night, so that you may be careful to do everything written in it. Then you will be prosperous and successful.
- 9 Haven't I commanded you? Strength! Courage! Don't be timid; don't get discouraged. GOD, your God, is with you every step you take."
- 9 Have I not commanded you? Be strong and courageous. Do not be terrified; do not be discouraged, for the LORD your God will be with you wherever you go."
- 10 Then Joshua gave orders to the people's leaders:
- 10 So Joshua ordered the officers of the people:
- 11 "Go through the camp and give this order to the people: 'Pack your bags. In three days you will cross this Jordan River to enter and take the land GOD, your God, is giving you to possess.'"
- 11 Go through the camp and tell the people, 'Get your supplies ready. Three days from now you will cross the Jordan here to go in and take possession of the land the LORD your God is giving you for your own.'
- 12 Then Joshua addressed the Reubenites, the Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh. He said,
- 12 But to the Reubenites, the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh, Joshua said,
- 13 "Remember what Moses the servant of GOD commanded you: GOD, your God, gives you rest and he gives you this land.
- 13 Remember the command that Moses the servant of the LORD gave you: 'The LORD your God is giving you rest and has granted you this land.'

- 14 Your wives, your children, and your livestock can stay here east of the Jordan, the country Moses gave you; but you, tough soldiers all, must cross the River in battle formation, leading your brothers, helping them
- 14 Your wives, your children and your livestock may stay in the land that Moses gave you east of the Jordan, but all your fighting men, fully armed, must cross over ahead of your brothers. You are to help your brothers
- 15 until GOD, your God, gives your brothers a place of rest just as he has done for you. They also will take possession of the land that GOD, your God, is giving them. Then you will be free to return to your possession, given to you by Moses the servant of GOD, across the Jordan to the east."
- 15 until the LORD gives them rest, as he has done for you, and until they too have taken possession of the land that the LORD your God is giving them. After that, you may go back and occupy your own land, which Moses the servant of the LORD gave you east of the Jordan toward the sunrise."
- 16 They answered Joshua: "Everything you commanded us, we'll do. Wherever you send us, we'll go.
- 16 Then they answered Joshua, "Whatever you have commanded us we will do, and wherever you send us we will go.
- 17 We obeyed Moses to the letter; we'll also obey you--we just pray that GOD, your God, will be with you as he was with Moses.
- 17 Just as we fully obeyed Moses, so we will obey you. Only may the LORD your God be with you as he was with Moses.
- 18 Anyone who questions what you say and refuses to obey whatever you command him will be put to death. Strength! Courage!"^
- 18 Whoever rebels against your word and does not obey your words, whatever you may command them, will be put to death. Only be strong and courageous!"

Joshua 2

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joshua son of Nun secretly sent out from Shittim two men as spies: "Go. Look over the land. Check out Jericho." They left and arrived at the house of a harlot named Rahab and stayed there.
- 1 Then Joshua son of Nun secretly sent two spies from Shittim. "Go, look over the land," he said, "especially Jericho." So they went and entered the house of a prostitute named Rahab and stayed there.
- 2 The king of Jericho was told, "We've just learned that men arrived tonight to spy out the land. They're from the People of Israel."
- 2 The king of Jericho was told, "Look! Some of the Israelites have come here tonight to spy out the land."
- 3 The king of Jericho sent word to Rahab: "Bring out the men who came to you to stay the night in your house. They're spies; they've come to spy out the whole country."
- 3 So the king of Jericho sent this message to Rahab: "Bring out the men who came to you and entered your house, because they have come to spy out the whole land."
- 4 The woman had taken the two men and hidden them. She said, "Yes, two men did come to me, but I didn't know where they'd come from."
- 4 But the woman had taken the two men and hidden them. She said, "Yes, the men came to me, but I did not know where they had come from."
- 5 At dark, when the gate was about to be shut, the men left. But I have no idea where they went. Hurry up! Chase them--you can still catch them!"
- 5 At dusk, when it was time to close the city gate, the men left. I don't know which way they went. Go after them quickly. You may catch up with them."
- 6 (She had actually taken them up on the roof and hidden them under the stalks of flax that were spread out for her on the roof.)
- 6 (But she had taken them up to the roof and hidden them under the stalks of flax she had laid out on the roof.)
- 7 So the men set chase down the Jordan road toward the fords. As soon as they were gone, the gate was shut.
- 7 So the men set out in pursuit of the spies on the road that leads to the fords of the Jordan, and as soon as the pursuers had gone out, the gate was shut.
- 8 Before the spies were down for the night, the woman came up to them on the roof

- 8 Before the spies lay down for the night, she went up on the roof
9 and said, "I know that GOD has given you the land. We're all afraid. Everyone in the country feels hopeless.
9 and said to them, "I know that the LORD has given this land to you and that a great fear of you has fallen on us, so that all who live in this country are melting in fear because of you.
10 We heard how GOD dried up the waters of the Red Sea before you when you left Egypt, and what he did to the two Amorite kings east of the Jordan, Sihon and Og, whom you put under a holy curse and destroyed.
10 We have heard how the LORD dried up the water of the Red Sea for you when you came out of Egypt, and what you did to Sihon and Og, the two kings of the Amorites east of the Jordan, whom you completely destroyed.
11 We heard it and our hearts sank. We all had the wind knocked out of us. And all because of you, you and GOD, your God, God of the heavens above and God of the earth below.
11 When we heard of it, our hearts melted and everyone's courage failed because of you, for the LORD your God is God in heaven above and on the earth below.
12 "Now promise me by GOD. I showed you mercy; now show my family mercy. And give me some tangible proof, a guarantee
12 Now then, please swear to me by the LORD that you will show kindness to my family, because I have shown kindness to you. Give me a sure sign
13 of life for my father and mother, my brothers and sisters--everyone connected with my family. Save our souls from death!"
13 that you will spare the lives of my father and mother, my brothers and sisters, and all who belong to them, and that you will save us from death."
14 "Our lives for yours!" said the men. "But don't tell anyone our business. When GOD turns this land over to us, we'll do right by you in loyal mercy."
14 Our lives for your lives! the men assured her. "If you don't tell what we are doing, we will treat you kindly and faithfully when the LORD gives us the land."

- 15 She lowered them down out a window with a rope because her house was on the city wall to the outside.
- 15 So she let them down by a rope through the window, for the house she lived in was part of the city wall.
- 16 She told them, "Run for the hills so your pursuers won't find you. Hide out for three days and give your pursuers time to return. Then get on your way."
- 16 Now she had said to them, "Go to the hills so the pursuers will not find you. Hide yourselves there three days until they return, and then go on your way."
- 17 The men told her, "In order to keep this oath you made us swear,
- 17 The men said to her, "This oath you made us swear will not be binding on us
- 18 here is what you must do: Hang this red rope out the window through which you let us down and gather your entire family with you in your house--father, mother, brothers, and sisters.
- 18 unless, when we enter the land, you have tied this scarlet cord in the window through which you let us down, and unless you have brought your father and mother, your brothers and all your family into your house.
- 19 Anyone who goes out the doors of your house into the street and is killed, it's his own fault--we aren't responsible. But for everyone within the house we take full responsibility. If anyone lays a hand on one of them, it's our fault.
- 19 If anyone goes outside your house into the street, his blood will be on his own head; we will not be responsible. As for anyone who is in the house with you, his blood will be on our head if a hand is laid on him.
- 20 But if you tell anyone of our business here, the oath you made us swear is canceled--we're no longer responsible."
- 20 But if you tell what we are doing, we will be released from the oath you made us swear."
- 21 She said, "If that's what you say, that's the way it is," and sent them off. They left and she hung the red rope out the window.
- 21 Agreed, she replied. "Let it be as you say." So she sent them away and they departed. And she tied the scarlet cord in the window.

- 22 They headed for the hills and stayed there for three days until the pursuers had returned. The pursuers had looked high and low but found nothing.
- 22 When they left, they went into the hills and stayed there three days, until the pursuers had searched all along the road and returned without finding them.
- 23 The men headed back. They came down out of the hills, crossed the river, and returned to Joshua son of Nun and reported all their experiences.
- 23 Then the two men started back. They went down out of the hills, forded the river and came to Joshua son of Nun and told him everything that had happened to them.
- 24 They told Joshua, "Yes! GOD has given the whole country to us. Everybody there is in a state of panic because of us."
- 24 They said to Joshua, "The LORD has surely given the whole land into our hands; all the people are melting in fear because of us."

Joshua 3

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joshua was up early and on his way from Shittim with all the People of Israel with him. He arrived at the Jordan and camped before crossing over.
- 1 Early in the morning Joshua and all the Israelites set out from Shittim and went to the Jordan, where they camped before crossing over.
- 2 After three days, leaders went through the camp
- 2 After three days the officers went throughout the camp,
- 3 and gave out orders to the people: "When you see the Covenant-Chest of GOD, your God, carried by the Levitical priests, start moving. Follow it.
- 3 giving orders to the people: "When you see the ark of the covenant of the LORD your God, and the priests, who are Levites, carrying it, you are to move out from your positions and follow it.
- 4 Make sure you keep a proper distance between you and it, about half a mile--be sure now to keep your distance!--and you'll see clearly the route to take. You've never been on this road before."

- 4 Then you will know which way to go, since you have never been this way before. But keep a distance of about a thousand yards between you and the ark; do not go near it."
- 5 Then Joshua addressed the people: "Sanctify yourselves. Tomorrow GOD will work miracle-wonders among you."
- 5 Joshua told the people, "Consecrate yourselves, for tomorrow the LORD will do amazing things among you."
- 6 Joshua instructed the priests, "Take up the Chest of the Covenant and step out before the people." So they took it up and processed before the people.
- 6 Joshua said to the priests, "Take up the ark of the covenant and pass on ahead of the people." So they took it up and went ahead of them.
- 7 GOD said to Joshua, "This very day I will begin to make you great in the eyes of all Israel. They'll see for themselves that I'm with you in the same way that I was with Moses.
- 7 And the LORD said to Joshua, "Today I will begin to exalt you in the eyes of all Israel, so they may know that I am with you as I was with Moses.
- 8 You will command the priests who are carrying the Chest of the Covenant: 'When you come to the edge of the Jordan's waters, stand there on the river bank.'"
- 8 Tell the priests who carry the ark of the covenant: 'When you reach the edge of the Jordan's waters, go and stand in the river.' "
- 9 Then Joshua addressed the People of Israel: "Attention! Listen to what GOD, your God, has to say.
- 9 Joshua said to the Israelites, "Come here and listen to the words of the LORD your God.
- 10 This is how you'll know that God is alive among you--he will completely dispossess before you the Canaanites, Hittites, Hivites, Perizzites, Girgashites, Amorites, and Jebusites.
- 10 This is how you will know that the living God is among you and that he will certainly drive out before you the Canaanites, Hittites, Hivites, Perizzites, Girgashites, Amorites and Jebusites.
- 11 Look at what's before you: the Chest of the Covenant. Think of it--the Master of the entire earth is crossing the Jordan as you watch.

- 11 See, the ark of the covenant of the Lord of all the earth will go into the Jordan ahead of you.
- 12 Now take twelve men from the tribes of Israel, one man from each tribe.
- 12 Now then, choose twelve men from the tribes of Israel, one from each tribe.
- 13 When the soles of the feet of the priests carrying the Chest of GOD, Master of all the earth, touch the Jordan's water, the flow of water will be stopped--the water coming from upstream will pile up in a heap."
- 13 And as soon as the priests who carry the ark of the LORD--the Lord of all the earth--set foot in the Jordan, its waters flowing downstream will be cut off and stand up in a heap."
- 14 And that's what happened. The people left their tents to cross the Jordan, led by the priests carrying the Chest of the Covenant.
- 14 So when the people broke camp to cross the Jordan, the priests carrying the ark of the covenant went ahead of them.
- 15 When the priests got to the Jordan and their feet touched the water at the edge (the Jordan overflows its banks throughout the harvest),
- 15 Now the Jordan is at flood stage all during harvest. Yet as soon as the priests who carried the ark reached the Jordan and their feet touched the water's edge,
- 16 the flow of water stopped. It piled up in a heap--a long way off--at Adam, which is near Zarethan. The river went dry all the way down to the Arabah Sea (the Salt Sea). And the people crossed, facing Jericho.
- 16 the water from upstream stopped flowing. It piled up in a heap a great distance away, at a town called Adam in the vicinity of Zarethan, while the water flowing down to the Sea of the Arabah (the Salt Sea) was completely cut off. So the people crossed over opposite Jericho.
- 17 And there they stood; those priests carrying the Chest of the Covenant stood firmly planted on dry ground in the middle of the Jordan while all Israel crossed on dry ground. Finally the whole nation was across the Jordan, and not one wet foot.
- 17 The priests who carried the ark of the covenant of the LORD stood firm on dry ground in the middle of the Jordan, while all Israel passed by until the whole nation had completed the crossing on dry ground.

Joshua 4

MSG

NIV

- 1 When the whole nation was finally across, GOD spoke to Joshua:
- 1 When the whole nation had finished crossing the Jordan, the LORD said to Joshua,
- 2 "Select twelve men from the people, a man from each tribe,
- 2 Choose twelve men from among the people, one from each tribe,
- 3 and tell them, 'From right here, the middle of the Jordan where the feet of the priests are standing firm, take twelve stones. Carry them across with you and set them down in the place where you camp tonight.'"
- 3 and tell them to take up twelve stones from the middle of the Jordan from right where the priests stood and to carry them over with you and put them down at the place where you stay tonight."
- 4 Joshua called out the twelve men whom he selected from the People of Israel, one man from each tribe.
- 4 So Joshua called together the twelve men he had appointed from the Israelites, one from each tribe,
- 5 Joshua directed them, "Cross to the middle of the Jordan and take your place in front of the Chest of GOD, your God. Each of you heft a stone to your shoulder, a stone for each of the tribes of the People of Israel,
- 5 and said to them, "Go over before the ark of the LORD your God into the middle of the Jordan. Each of you is to take up a stone on his shoulder, according to the number of the tribes of the Israelites,
- 6 so you'll have something later to mark the occasion. When your children ask you, 'What are these stones to you?'
- 6 to serve as a sign among you. In the future, when your children ask you, 'What do these stones mean?'
- 7 you'll say, 'The flow of the Jordan was stopped in front of the Chest of the Covenant of GOD as it crossed the Jordan--stopped in its tracks. These stones are a permanent memorial for the People of Israel.'"
- 7 tell them that the flow of the Jordan was cut off before the ark of the covenant of the LORD. When it crossed the Jordan, the waters of the Jordan were cut off. These stones are to be a memorial to the people of Israel forever."

- 8 The People of Israel did exactly as Joshua commanded: They took twelve stones from the middle of the Jordan--a stone for each of the twelve tribes, just as GOD had instructed Joshua--carried them across with them to the camp, and set them down there.
- 8 So the Israelites did as Joshua commanded them. They took twelve stones from the middle of the Jordan, according to the number of the tribes of the Israelites, as the LORD had told Joshua; and they carried them over with them to their camp, where they put them down.
- 9 Joshua set up the twelve stones taken from the middle of the Jordan that had marked the place where the priests who carried the Chest of the Covenant had stood. They are still there today.
- 9 Joshua set up the twelve stones that had been in the middle of the Jordan at the spot where the priests who carried the ark of the covenant had stood. And they are there to this day.
- 10 The priests carrying the Chest continued standing in the middle of the Jordan until everything GOD had instructed Joshua to tell the people to do was done (confirming what Moses had instructed Joshua). The people crossed; no one dawdled.
- 10 Now the priests who carried the ark remained standing in the middle of the Jordan until everything the LORD had commanded Joshua was done by the people, just as Moses had directed Joshua. The people hurried over,
- 11 When the crossing of all the people was complete, they watched as the Chest of the Covenant and the priests crossed over.
- 11 and as soon as all of them had crossed, the ark of the LORD and the priests came to the other side while the people watched.
- 12 The Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had crossed over in battle formation in front of the People of Israel, obedient to Moses' instructions.
- 12 The men of Reuben, Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh crossed over, armed, in front of the Israelites, as Moses had directed them.
- 13 All told, about 40,000 armed soldiers crossed over before GOD to the plains of Jericho, ready for battle.
- 13 About forty thousand armed for battle crossed over before the LORD to the plains of Jericho for war.

14 GOD made Joshua great that day in the sight of all Israel. They were in awe of him just as they had been in awe of Moses all his life.

14 That day the LORD exalted Joshua in the sight of all Israel; and they revered him all the days of his life, just as they had revered Moses.

15 GOD told Joshua,

15 Then the LORD said to Joshua,

16 "Command the priests carrying the Chest of the Testimony to come up from the Jordan."

16 Command the priests carrying the ark of the Testimony to come up out of the Jordan.

17 Joshua commanded the priests, "Come up out of the Jordan."

17 So Joshua commanded the priests, "Come up out of the Jordan."

18 They did it. The priests carrying GOD's Chest of the Covenant came up from the middle of the Jordan. As soon as the soles of the priests' feet touched dry land, the Jordan's waters resumed their flow within the banks, just as before.

18 And the priests came up out of the river carrying the ark of the covenant of the LORD. No sooner had they set their feet on the dry ground than the waters of the Jordan returned to their place and ran at flood stage as before.

19 The people came up out of the Jordan on the tenth day of the first month. They set up camp at The Gilgal (The Circle) to the east of Jericho.

19 On the tenth day of the first month the people went up from the Jordan and camped at Gilgal on the eastern border of Jericho.

20 Joshua erected a monument at The Gilgal, using the twelve stones that they had taken from the Jordan.

20 And Joshua set up at Gilgal the twelve stones they had taken out of the Jordan.

21 And then he told the People of Israel, "In the days to come, when your children ask their fathers, 'What are these stones doing here?'

21 He said to the Israelites, "In the future when your descendants ask their fathers, 'What do these stones mean?'

22 tell your children this: 'Israel crossed over this Jordan on dry ground.'

22 tell them, 'Israel crossed the Jordan on dry ground.'

- 23 "Yes, GOD, your God, dried up the Jordan's waters for you until you had crossed, just as GOD, your God, did at the Red Sea, which had dried up before us until we had crossed.
- 23 For the LORD your God dried up the Jordan before you until you had crossed over. The LORD your God did to the Jordan just what he had done to the Red Sea when he dried it up before us until we had crossed over.
- 24 This was so that everybody on earth would recognize how strong GOD's rescuing hand is and so that you would hold GOD in solemn reverence always."
- 24 He did this so that all the peoples of the earth might know that the hand of the LORD is powerful and so that you might always fear the LORD your God."

Joshua 5

MSG

NIV

- 1 When all the Amorite kings west of the Jordan and the Canaanite kings along the seacoast heard how GOD had stopped the Jordan River before the People of Israel until they had crossed over, their hearts sank; the courage drained out of them just thinking about the People of Israel.
- 1 Now when all the Amorite kings west of the Jordan and all the Canaanite kings along the coast heard how the LORD had dried up the Jordan before the Israelites until we had crossed over, their hearts melted and they no longer had the courage to face the Israelites.
- 2 At that time GOD said to Joshua, "Make stone knives and circumcise the People of Israel a second time."
- 2 At that time the LORD said to Joshua, "Make flint knives and circumcise the Israelites again."
- 3 So Joshua made stone knives and circumcised the People of Israel at Foreskins Hill.
- 3 So Joshua made flint knives and circumcised the Israelites at Gibeath Haaraloth.
- 4 This is why Joshua conducted the circumcision. All the males who had left Egypt, the soldiers, had died in the wilderness on the journey out of

Egypt.

- 4 Now this is why he did so: All those who came out of Egypt--all the men of military age--died in the desert on the way after leaving Egypt.
- 5 All the people who had come out of Egypt, of course, had been circumcised, but all those born in the wilderness along the way since leaving Egypt had not been.
- 5 All the people that came out had been circumcised, but all the people born in the desert during the journey from Egypt had not.
- 6 The fact is that the People of Israel had walked through that wilderness for forty years until the entire nation died out, all the men of military age who had come out of Egypt but had disobeyed the call of GOD. GOD vowed that these would never lay eyes on the land GOD had solemnly promised their ancestors to give us, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 6 The Israelites had moved about in the desert forty years until all the men who were of military age when they left Egypt had died, since they had not obeyed the LORD. For the LORD had sworn to them that they would not see the land that he had solemnly promised their fathers to give us, a land flowing with milk and honey.
- 7 But their children had replaced them. These are the ones Joshua circumcised. They had never been circumcised; no one had circumcised them along the way.
- 7 So he raised up their sons in their place, and these were the ones Joshua circumcised. They were still uncircumcised because they had not been circumcised on the way.
- 8 When they had completed the circumcising of the whole nation, they stayed where they were in camp until they were healed.
- 8 And after the whole nation had been circumcised, they remained where they were in camp until they were healed.
- 9 GOD said to Joshua, "Today I have rolled away the reproach of Egypt." That's why the place is called The Gilgal. It's still called that.
- 9 Then the LORD said to Joshua, "Today I have rolled away the reproach of Egypt from you." So the place has been called Gilgal to this day.
- 10 The People of Israel continued to camp at The Gilgal. They celebrated the Passover on the evening of the fourteenth day of the month on the plains of Jericho.

- 10 On the evening of the fourteenth day of the month, while camped at Gilgal on the plains of Jericho, the Israelites celebrated the Passover.
- 11 Right away, the day after the Passover, they started eating the produce of that country, unraised bread and roasted grain.
- 11 The day after the Passover, that very day, they ate some of the produce of the land: unleavened bread and roasted grain.
- 12 And then no more manna; the manna stopped. As soon as they started eating food grown in the land, there was no more manna for the People of Israel. That year they ate from the crops of Canaan.
- 12 The manna stopped the day after they ate this food from the land; there was no longer any manna for the Israelites, but that year they ate of the produce of Canaan.
- 13 And then this, while Joshua was there near Jericho: He looked up and saw right in front of him a man standing, holding his drawn sword. Joshua stepped up to him and said, "Whose side are you on--ours or our enemies'?"
- 13 Now when Joshua was near Jericho, he looked up and saw a man standing in front of him with a drawn sword in his hand. Joshua went up to him and asked, "Are you for us or for our enemies?"
- 14 He said, "Neither. I'm commander of GOD's army. I've just arrived." Joshua fell, face to the ground, and worshiped. He asked, "What orders does my Master have for his servant?"
- 14 Neither, he replied, "but as commander of the army of the LORD I have now come." Then Joshua fell facedown to the ground in reverence, and asked him, "What message does my Lord have for his servant?"
- 15 GOD's army commander ordered Joshua, "Take your sandals off your feet. The place you are standing is holy." Joshua did it.
- 15 The commander of the LORD's army replied, "Take off your sandals, for the place where you are standing is holy." And Joshua did so.

Joshua 6

MSG

NIV

- 1 Jericho was shut up tight as a drum because of the People of Israel: no one going in, no one coming out.

- 1 Now Jericho was tightly shut up because of the Israelites. No one went out and no one came in.
- 2 GOD spoke to Joshua, "Look sharp now. I've already given Jericho to you, along with its king and its crack troops.
- 2 Then the LORD said to Joshua, "See, I have delivered Jericho into your hands, along with its king and its fighting men.
- 3 Here's what you are to do: March around the city, all your soldiers. Circle the city once. Repeat this for six days.
- 3 March around the city once with all the armed men. Do this for six days.
- 4 Have seven priests carry seven ram's horn trumpets in front of the Chest. On the seventh day march around the city seven times, the priests blowing away on the trumpets.
- 4 Have seven priests carry trumpets of rams' horns in front of the ark. On the seventh day, march around the city seven times, with the priests blowing the trumpets.
- 5 And then, a long blast on the ram's horn--when you hear that, all the people are to shout at the top of their lungs. The city wall will collapse at once. All the people are to enter, every man straight on in."
- 5 When you hear them sound a long blast on the trumpets, have all the people give a loud shout; then the wall of the city will collapse and the people will go up, every man straight in."
- 6 So Joshua son of Nun called the priests and told them, "Take up the Chest of the Covenant. Seven priests are to carry seven ram's horn trumpets leading GOD's Chest."
- 6 So Joshua son of Nun called the priests and said to them, "Take up the ark of the covenant of the LORD and have seven priests carry trumpets in front of it."
- 7 Then he told the people, "Set out! March around the city. Have the armed guard march before the Chest of GOD."
- 7 And he ordered the people, "Advance! March around the city, with the armed guard going ahead of the ark of the LORD."
- 8 And it happened. Joshua spoke, the people moved: Seven priests with their seven ram's horn trumpets set out before GOD. They blew the trumpets, leading GOD's Chest of the Covenant.
- 8 When Joshua had spoken to the people, the seven priests carrying the seven trumpets before the LORD went forward, blowing their trumpets,

and the ark of the LORD's covenant followed them.

- 9 The armed guard marched ahead of the trumpet-blowing priests; the rear guard was marching after the Chest, marching and blowing their trumpets.
- 9 The armed guard marched ahead of the priests who blew the trumpets, and the rear guard followed the ark. All this time the trumpets were sounding.
- 10 Joshua had given orders to the people, "Don't shout. In fact, don't even speak--not so much as a whisper until you hear me say, 'Shout!'--then shout away!"
- 10 But Joshua had commanded the people, "Do not give a war cry, do not raise your voices, do not say a word until the day I tell you to shout. Then shout!"
- 11 He sent the Chest of GOD on its way around the city. It circled once, came back to camp, and stayed for the night.
- 11 So he had the ark of the LORD carried around the city, circling it once. Then the people returned to camp and spent the night there.
- 12 Joshua was up early the next morning and the priests took up the Chest of GOD.
- 12 Joshua got up early the next morning and the priests took up the ark of the LORD.
- 13 The seven priests carrying the seven ram's horn trumpets marched before the Chest of GOD, marching and blowing the trumpets, with the armed guard marching before and the rear guard marching after. Marching and blowing of trumpets!
- 13 The seven priests carrying the seven trumpets went forward, marching before the ark of the LORD and blowing the trumpets. The armed men went ahead of them and the rear guard followed the ark of the LORD, while the trumpets kept sounding.
- 14 On the second day they again circled the city once and returned to camp. They did this six days.
- 14 So on the second day they marched around the city once and returned to the camp. They did this for six days.
- 15 When the seventh day came, they got up early and marched around the city this same way but seven times--yes, this day they circled the city seven times.

- 15 On the seventh day, they got up at daybreak and marched around the city seven times in the same manner, except that on that day they circled the city seven times.
- 16 On the seventh time around the priests blew the trumpets and Joshua signaled the people, "Shout!--GOD has given you the city!"
- 16 The seventh time around, when the priests sounded the trumpet blast, Joshua commanded the people, "Shout! For the LORD has given you the city!"
- 17 The city and everything in it is under a holy curse and offered up to GOD. "Except for Rahab the harlot--she is to live, she and everyone in her house with her, because she hid the agents we sent.
- 17 The city and all that is in it are to be devoted to the LORD. Only Rahab the prostitute and all who are with her in her house shall be spared, because she hid the spies we sent.
- 18 "As for you, watch yourselves in the city under holy curse. Be careful that you don't covet anything in it and take something that's cursed, endangering the camp of Israel with the curse and making trouble for everyone.
- 18 But keep away from the devoted things, so that you will not bring about your own destruction by taking any of them. Otherwise you will make the camp of Israel liable to destruction and bring trouble on it.
- 19 All silver and gold, all vessels of bronze and iron are holy to GOD. Put them in GOD's treasury."
- 19 All the silver and gold and the articles of bronze and iron are sacred to the LORD and must go into his treasury."
- 20 The priests blew the trumpets. When the people heard the blast of the trumpets, they gave a thunderclap shout. The wall fell at once. The people rushed straight into the city and took it.
- 20 When the trumpets sounded, the people shouted, and at the sound of the trumpet, when the people gave a loud shout, the wall collapsed; so every man charged straight in, and they took the city.
- 21 They put everything in the city under the holy curse, killing man and woman, young and old, ox and sheep and donkey.
- 21 They devoted the city to the LORD and destroyed with the sword every living thing in it--men and women, young and old, cattle, sheep and donkeys.

- 22 Joshua ordered the two men who had spied out the land, "Enter the house of the harlot and rescue the woman and everyone connected with her, just as you promised her."
- 22 Joshua said to the two men who had spied out the land, "Go into the prostitute's house and bring her out and all who belong to her, in accordance with your oath to her."
- 23 So the young spies went in and brought out Rahab, her father, mother, and brothers--everyone connected with her. They got the whole family out and gave them a place outside the camp of Israel.
- 23 So the young men who had done the spying went in and brought out Rahab, her father and mother and brothers and all who belonged to her. They brought out her entire family and put them in a place outside the camp of Israel.
- 24 But they burned down the city and everything in it, except for the gold and silver and the bronze and iron vessels--all that they put in the treasury of GOD's house.
- 24 Then they burned the whole city and everything in it, but they put the silver and gold and the articles of bronze and iron into the treasury of the LORD's house.
- 25 But Joshua let Rahab the harlot live--Rahab and her father's household and everyone connected to her. She is still alive and well in Israel because she hid the agents whom Joshua sent to spy out Jericho.
- 25 But Joshua spared Rahab the prostitute, with her family and all who belonged to her, because she hid the men Joshua had sent as spies to Jericho--and she lives among the Israelites to this day.
- 26 Joshua swore a solemn oath at that time: Cursed before GOD is the man who sets out to rebuild this city Jericho. He'll pay for the foundation with his firstborn son, he'll pay for the gates with his youngest son.
- 26 At that time Joshua pronounced this solemn oath: "Cursed before the LORD is the man who undertakes to rebuild this city, Jericho: "At the cost of his firstborn son will he lay its foundations; at the cost of his youngest will he set up its gates."
- 27 GOD was with Joshua. He became famous all over the land.
- 27 So the LORD was with Joshua, and his fame spread throughout the land.

Joshua 7

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then the People of Israel violated the holy curse. Achan son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah of the tribe of Judah, took some of the cursed things. GOD became angry with the People of Israel.
- 1 But the Israelites acted unfaithfully in regard to the devoted things; Achan son of Carmi, the son of Zimri, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, took some of them. So the LORD's anger burned against Israel.
- 2 Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai (The Ruin), which is near Beth Aven just east of Bethel. He instructed them, "Go up and spy out the land." The men went up and spied out Ai.
- 2 Now Joshua sent men from Jericho to Ai, which is near Beth Aven to the east of Bethel, and told them, "Go up and spy out the region." So the men went up and spied out Ai.
- 3 They returned to Joshua and reported, "Don't bother sending a lot of people--two or three thousand men are enough to defeat Ai. Don't wear out the whole army; there aren't that many people there."
- 3 When they returned to Joshua, they said, "Not all the people will have to go up against Ai. Send two or three thousand men to take it and do not weary all the people, for only a few men are there."
- 4 So three thousand men went up--and then fled in defeat before the men of Ai!
- 4 So about three thousand men went up; but they were routed by the men of Ai,
- 5 The men of Ai killed thirty-six--chased them from the city gate as far as The Quarries, killing them at the descent. The heart of the people sank, all spirit knocked out of them.
- 5 who killed about thirty-six of them. They chased the Israelites from the city gate as far as the stone quarries and struck them down on the slopes. At this the hearts of the people melted and became like water.
- 6 Joshua ripped his clothes and fell on his face to the ground before the Chest of GOD, he and the leaders throwing dirt on their heads, prostrate until evening.

- 6 Then Joshua tore his clothes and fell facedown to the ground before the ark of the LORD, remaining there till evening. The elders of Israel did the same, and sprinkled dust on their heads.
- 7 Joshua said, "Oh, oh, oh . . . Master, GOD. Why did you insist on bringing this people across the Jordan? To make us victims of the Amorites? To wipe us out? Why didn't we just settle down on the east side of the Jordan?"
- 7 And Joshua said, "Ah, Sovereign LORD, why did you ever bring this people across the Jordan to deliver us into the hands of the Amorites to destroy us? If only we had been content to stay on the other side of the Jordan!"
- 8 Oh, Master, what can I say after this, after Israel has been run off by its enemies?
- 8 O Lord, what can I say, now that Israel has been routed by its enemies?
- 9 When the Canaanites and all the others living here get wind of this, they'll gang up on us and make short work of us--and then how will you keep up your reputation?"
- 9 The Canaanites and the other people of the country will hear about this and they will surround us and wipe out our name from the earth. What then will you do for your own great name?"
- 10 GOD said to Joshua, "Get up. Why are you groveling?"
- 10 The LORD said to Joshua, "Stand up! What are you doing down on your face?"
- 11 Israel has sinned: They've broken the covenant I commanded them; they've taken forbidden plunder--stolen and then covered up the theft, squirreling it away with their own stuff.
- 11 Israel has sinned; they have violated my covenant, which I commanded them to keep. They have taken some of the devoted things; they have stolen, they have lied, they have put them with their own possessions.
- 12 The People of Israel can no longer look their enemies in the eye--they themselves are plunder. I can't continue with you if you don't rid yourselves of the cursed things.
- 12 That is why the Israelites cannot stand against their enemies; they turn their backs and run because they have been made liable to destruction. I will not be with you anymore unless you destroy whatever among you is devoted to destruction.

- 13 "So get started. Purify the people. Tell them: Get ready for tomorrow by purifying yourselves. For this is what GOD, the God of Israel, says: There are cursed things in the camp. You won't be able to face your enemies until you have gotten rid of these cursed things.
- 13 Go, consecrate the people. Tell them, 'Consecrate yourselves in preparation for tomorrow; for this is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: That which is devoted is among you, O Israel. You cannot stand against your enemies until you remove it.
- 14 "First thing in the morning you will be called up by tribes. The tribe GOD names will come up clan by clan; the clan GOD names will come up family by family; and the family GOD names will come up man by man.
- 14 'In the morning, present yourselves tribe by tribe. The tribe that the LORD takes shall come forward clan by clan; the clan that the LORD takes shall come forward family by family; and the family that the LORD takes shall come forward man by man.
- 15 The person found with the cursed things will be burned, he and everything he has, because he broke GOD's covenant and did this despicable thing in Israel."
- 15 He who is caught with the devoted things shall be destroyed by fire, along with all that belongs to him. He has violated the covenant of the LORD and has done a disgraceful thing in Israel!" "
- 16 Joshua was up at the crack of dawn and called Israel up tribe by tribe. The tribe of Judah was singled out.
- 16 Early the next morning Joshua had Israel come forward by tribes, and Judah was taken.
- 17 Then he called up the clans and singled out the Zerahites. He called up the Zerahite families and singled out the Zabdi family.
- 17 The clans of Judah came forward, and he took the Zerahites. He had the clan of the Zerahites come forward by families, and Zimri was taken.
- 18 He called up the family members one by one and singled out Achan son of Carmi, the son of Zabdi, the son of Zerah of the tribe of Judah.
- 18 Joshua had his family come forward man by man, and Achan son of Carmi, the son of Zimri, the son of Zerah, of the tribe of Judah, was taken.

- 19 Joshua spoke to Achan, "My son, give glory to GOD, the God of Israel. Make your confession to him. Tell me what you did. Don't keep back anything from me."
- 19 Then Joshua said to Achan, "My son, give glory to the LORD, the God of Israel, and give him the praise. Tell me what you have done; do not hide it from me."
- 20 Achan answered Joshua, "It's true. I sinned against GOD, the God of Israel. This is how I did it.
- 20 Achan replied, "It is true! I have sinned against the LORD, the God of Israel. This is what I have done:
- 21 In the plunder I spotted a beautiful Shinar robe, two hundred shekels of silver, and a fifty-shekel bar of gold, and I coveted and took them. They are buried in my tent with the silver at the bottom."
- 21 When I saw in the plunder a beautiful robe from Babylonia, two hundred shekels of silver and a wedge of gold weighing fifty shekels, I coveted them and took them. They are hidden in the ground inside my tent, with the silver underneath."
- 22 Joshua sent off messengers. They ran to the tent. And there it was, buried in the tent with the silver at the bottom.
- 22 So Joshua sent messengers, and they ran to the tent, and there it was, hidden in his tent, with the silver underneath.
- 23 They took the stuff from the tent and brought it to Joshua and to all the People of Israel and spread it out before GOD.
- 23 They took the things from the tent, brought them to Joshua and all the Israelites and spread them out before the LORD.
- 24 Joshua took Achan son of Zerah, took the silver, the robe, the gold bar, his sons and daughters, his ox, donkey, sheep, and tent--everything connected with him. All Israel was there. They led them off to the Valley of Achor (Trouble Valley).
- 24 Then Joshua, together with all Israel, took Achan son of Zerah, the silver, the robe, the gold wedge, his sons and daughters, his cattle, donkeys and sheep, his tent and all that he had, to the Valley of Achor.
- 25 Joshua said, "Why have you troubled us? GOD will now trouble you. Today!" And all Israel stoned him--burned him with fire and stoned him with stones.

- 25 Joshua said, "Why have you brought this trouble on us? The LORD will bring trouble on you today." Then all Israel stoned him, and after they had stoned the rest, they burned them.
- 26 They piled a huge pile of stones over him. It's still there. Only then did GOD turn from his hot anger. That's how the place came to be called Trouble Valley right up to the present time.
- 26 Over Achan they heaped up a large pile of rocks, which remains to this day. Then the LORD turned from his fierce anger. Therefore that place has been called the Valley of Achor ever since.

Joshua 8

MSG

NIV

- 1 GOD said to Joshua, "Don't be timid and don't so much as hesitate. Take all your soldiers with you and go back to Ai. I have turned the king of Ai over to you--his people, his city, and his land.
- 1 Then the LORD said to Joshua, "Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged. Take the whole army with you, and go up and attack Ai. For I have delivered into your hands the king of Ai, his people, his city and his land.
- 2 "Do to Ai and its king what you did to Jericho and its king. Only this time you may plunder its stuff and cattle to your heart's content. Set an ambush behind the city."
- 2 You shall do to Ai and its king as you did to Jericho and its king, except that you may carry off their plunder and livestock for yourselves. Set an ambush behind the city."
- 3 Joshua and all his soldiers got ready to march on Ai. Joshua chose thirty thousand men, tough, seasoned fighters, and sent them off at night
- 3 So Joshua and the whole army moved out to attack Ai. He chose thirty thousand of his best fighting men and sent them out at night
- 4 with these orders: "Look sharp now. Lie in ambush behind the city. Get as close as you can. Stay alert.
- 4 with these orders: "Listen carefully. You are to set an ambush behind the city. Don't go very far from it. All of you be on the alert.

- 5 I and the troops with me will approach the city head-on. When they come out to meet us just as before, we'll turn and run.
- 5 I and all those with me will advance on the city, and when the men come out against us, as they did before, we will flee from them.
- 6 They'll come after us, leaving the city. As we are off and running, they'll say, 'They're running away just like the first time.'
- 6 They will pursue us until we have lured them away from the city, for they will say, 'They are running away from us as they did before.' So when we flee from them,
- 7 That's your signal to spring from your ambush and take the city. GOD, your God, will hand it to you on a platter.
- 7 you are to rise up from ambush and take the city. The LORD your God will give it into your hand.
- 8 Once you have the city, burn it down. GOD says it, you do it. Go to it. I've given you your orders."
- 8 When you have taken the city, set it on fire. Do what the LORD has commanded. See to it; you have my orders."
- 9 Joshua sent them off. They set their ambush and waited between Bethel and Ai, just west of Ai. Joshua spent the night with the people.
- 9 Then Joshua sent them off, and they went to the place of ambush and lay in wait between Bethel and Ai, to the west of Ai--but Joshua spent that night with the people.
- 10 Joshua was up early in the morning and mustered his army. He and the leaders of Israel led the troops to Ai.
- 10 Early the next morning Joshua mustered his men, and he and the leaders of Israel marched before them to Ai.
- 11 The whole army, fighting men all, marched right up within sight of the city and set camp on the north side of Ai. There was a valley between them and Ai.
- 11 The entire force that was with him marched up and approached the city and arrived in front of it. They set up camp north of Ai, with the valley between them and the city.
- 12 He had taken about five thousand men and put them in ambush between Bethel and Ai, west of the city.
- 12 Joshua had taken about five thousand men and set them in ambush between Bethel and Ai, to the west of the city.

- 13 They were all deployed, the main army to the north of the city and the ambush to the west. Joshua spent the night in the valley.
- 13 They had the soldiers take up their positions--all those in the camp to the north of the city and the ambush to the west of it. That night Joshua went into the valley.
- 14 So it happened that when the king of Ai saw all this, the men of the city lost no time; they were out of there at the crack of dawn to join Israel in battle, the king and his troops, at a field en route to the Arabah. The king didn't know of the ambush set against him behind the city.
- 14 When the king of Ai saw this, he and all the men of the city hurried out early in the morning to meet Israel in battle at a certain place overlooking the Arabah. But he did not know that an ambush had been set against him behind the city.
- 15 Joshua and all Israel let themselves be chased; they ran toward the wilderness.
- 15 Joshua and all Israel let themselves be driven back before them, and they fled toward the desert.
- 16 Everybody in the city was called to the chase. They pursued Joshua and were led away from the city.
- 16 All the men of Ai were called to pursue them, and they pursued Joshua and were lured away from the city.
- 17 There wasn't a soul left in Ai or Bethel who wasn't out there chasing after Israel. The city was left empty and undefended as they were chasing Israel down.
- 17 Not a man remained in Ai or Bethel who did not go after Israel. They left the city open and went in pursuit of Israel.
- 18 Then GOD spoke to Joshua: "Stretch out the javelin in your hand toward Ai--I'm giving it to you." Joshua stretched out the javelin in his hand toward Ai.
- 18 Then the LORD said to Joshua, "Hold out toward Ai the javelin that is in your hand, for into your hand I will deliver the city." So Joshua held out his javelin toward Ai.
- 19 At the signal the men in ambush sprang to their feet, ran to the city, took it, and quickly had it up in flames.
- 19 As soon as he did this, the men in the ambush rose quickly from their position and rushed forward. They entered the city and captured it and

quickly set it on fire.

20 The men of Ai looked back and, oh! saw the city going up in smoke. They found themselves trapped with nowhere to run.

20 The men of Ai looked back and saw the smoke of the city rising against the sky, but they had no chance to escape in any direction, for the Israelites who had been fleeing toward the desert had turned back against their pursuers.

21 The army on the run toward the wilderness did an about-face--Joshua and all Israel, seeing that the ambush had taken the city, saw it going up in smoke, turned and attacked the men of Ai.

21 For when Joshua and all Israel saw that the ambush had taken the city and that smoke was going up from the city, they turned around and attacked the men of Ai.

22 Then the men in the ambush poured out of the city. The men of Ai were caught in the middle with Israelites on both sides--a real massacre. And not a single survivor.

22 The men of the ambush also came out of the city against them, so that they were caught in the middle, with Israelites on both sides. Israel cut them down, leaving them neither survivors nor fugitives.

23 Except for the king of Ai; they took him alive and brought him to Joshua.

23 But they took the king of Ai alive and brought him to Joshua.

24 When it was all over, Israel had killed everyone in Ai, whether in the fields or in the wilderness where they had chased them. When the killing was complete, the Israelites returned to Ai and completed the devastation.

24 When Israel had finished killing all the men of Ai in the fields and in the desert where they had chased them, and when every one of them had been put to the sword, all the Israelites returned to Ai and killed those who were in it.

25 The death toll that day came to 12,000 men and women--everyone in Ai.

25 Twelve thousand men and women fell that day--all the people of Ai.

26 Joshua didn't lower his outstretched javelin until the sacred destruction of Ai and all its people was completed.

- 26 For Joshua did not draw back the hand that held out his javelin until he had destroyed all who lived in Ai.
- 27 Israel did get to take the livestock and loot left in the city; GOD's instructions to Joshua allowed for that.
- 27 But Israel did carry off for themselves the livestock and plunder of this city, as the LORD had instructed Joshua.
- 28 Joshua burned Ai to the ground. A "heap" of nothing forever, a "no-place"--go see for yourself.
- 28 So Joshua burned Ai and made it a permanent heap of ruins, a desolate place to this day.
- 29 He hanged the king of Ai from a tree. At evening, with the sun going down, Joshua ordered the corpse cut down. They dumped it at the entrance to the city and piled it high with stones--you can go see that also.
- 29 He hung the king of Ai on a tree and left him there until evening. At sunset, Joshua ordered them to take his body from the tree and throw it down at the entrance of the city gate. And they raised a large pile of rocks over it, which remains to this day.
- 30 Then Joshua built an altar to the GOD of Israel on Mount Ebal.
- 30 Then Joshua built on Mount Ebal an altar to the LORD, the God of Israel,
- 31 He built it following the instructions of Moses the servant of GOD to the People of Israel and written in the Book of The Revelation of Moses, an altar of whole stones that hadn't been chiseled or shaped by an iron tool. On it they offered to GOD Whole-Burnt-Offerings and sacrificed Peace-Offerings.
- 31 as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded the Israelites. He built it according to what is written in the Book of the Law of Moses--an altar of uncut stones, on which no iron tool had been used. On it they offered to the LORD burnt offerings and sacrificed fellowship offerings.
- 32 He also wrote out a copy of The Revelation of Moses on the stones. He wrote it with the People of Israel looking on.
- 32 There, in the presence of the Israelites, Joshua copied on stones the law of Moses, which he had written.
- 33 All Israel was there, foreigners and citizens alike, with their elders, officers, and judges, standing on opposite sides of the Chest, facing the

Levitical priests who carry GOD's Covenant Chest. Half of the people stood with their backs to Mount Gerizim and half with their backs to Mount Ebal to bless the People of Israel, just as Moses the servant of GOD had instructed earlier.

- 33 All Israel, aliens and citizens alike, with their elders, officials and judges, were standing on both sides of the ark of the covenant of the LORD, facing those who carried it--the priests, who were Levites. Half of the people stood in front of Mount Gerizim and half of them in front of Mount Ebal, as Moses the servant of the LORD had formerly commanded when he gave instructions to bless the people of Israel.
- 34 After that, he read out everything written in The Revelation, the Blessing and the Curse, everything in the Book of The Revelation.
- 34 Afterward, Joshua read all the words of the law--the blessings and the curses--just as it is written in the Book of the Law.
- 35 There wasn't a word of all that Moses commanded that Joshua didn't read to the entire congregation--men, women, children, and foreigners who had been with them on the journey.
- 35 There was not a word of all that Moses had commanded that Joshua did not read to the whole assembly of Israel, including the women and children, and the aliens who lived among them.

Joshua 9

MSG

NIV

- 1 All the kings west of the Jordan in the hills and foothills and along the Mediterranean seacoast north toward Lebanon--the Hittites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites, Girgashites, and Jebusites--got the news.
- 1 Now when all the kings west of the Jordan heard about these things--those in the hill country, in the western foothills, and along the entire coast of the Great Sea as far as Lebanon (the kings of the Hittites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites)--
- 2 They came together in a coalition to fight against Joshua and Israel under a single command.
- 2 they came together to make war against Joshua and Israel.
- 3 The people of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done to Jericho and Ai

3 However, when the people of Gibeon heard what Joshua had done to Jericho and Ai,
4 and cooked up a ruse. They posed as travelers: their donkeys loaded with patched sacks and mended wineskins,
4 they resorted to a ruse: They went as a delegation whose donkeys were loaded with worn-out sacks and old wineskins, cracked and mended.
5 threadbare sandals on their feet, tattered clothes on their bodies, nothing but dry crusts and crumbs for food.
5 The men put worn and patched sandals on their feet and wore old clothes. All the bread of their food supply was dry and moldy.
6 They came to Joshua at Gilgal and spoke to the men of Israel, "We've come from a far-off country; make a covenant with us."
6 Then they went to Joshua in the camp at Gilgal and said to him and the men of Israel, "We have come from a distant country; make a treaty with us."
7 The men of Israel said to these Hivites, "How do we know you aren't local people? How could we then make a covenant with you?"
7 The men of Israel said to the Hivites, "But perhaps you live near us. How then can we make a treaty with you?"
8 They said to Joshua, "We'll be your servants." Joshua said, "Who are you now? Where did you come from?"
8 We are your servants, they said to Joshua. But Joshua asked, "Who are you and where do you come from?"
9 They said, "From a far-off country, very far away. Your servants came because we'd heard such great things about GOD, your God--all those things he did in Egypt!
9 They answered: "Your servants have come from a very distant country because of the fame of the LORD your God. For we have heard reports of him: all that he did in Egypt,
10 And the two Amorite kings across the Jordan, King Sihon of Heshbon and King Og of Bashan, who ruled in Ashtaroth!
10 and all that he did to the two kings of the Amorites east of the Jordan--Sihon king of Heshbon, and Og king of Bashan, who reigned in Ashtaroth.
11 Our leaders and everybody else in our country told us, 'Pack up some food for the road and go meet them. Tell them, We're your servants;

make a covenant with us.'

11 And our elders and all those living in our country said to us, 'Take provisions for your journey; go and meet them and say to them, "We are your servants; make a treaty with us." '

12 "This bread was warm from the oven when we packed it and left to come and see you. Now look at it--crusts and crumbs.

12 This bread of ours was warm when we packed it at home on the day we left to come to you. But now see how dry and moldy it is.

13 And our cracked and mended wineskins, good as new when we filled them. And our clothes and sandals, in tatters from the long, hard traveling."

13 And these wineskins that we filled were new, but see how cracked they are. And our clothes and sandals are worn out by the very long journey."

14 The men of Israel looked them over and accepted the evidence. But they didn't ask GOD about it.

14 The men of Israel sampled their provisions but did not inquire of the LORD.

15 So Joshua made peace with them and formalized it with a covenant to guarantee their lives. The leaders of the congregation swore to it.

15 Then Joshua made a treaty of peace with them to let them live, and the leaders of the assembly ratified it by oath.

16 And then, three days after making this covenant, they learned that they were next-door neighbors who had been living there all along!

16 Three days after they made the treaty with the Gibeonites, the Israelites heard that they were neighbors, living near them.

17 The People of Israel broke camp and set out; three days later they reached their towns--Gibeon, Kephirah, Beeroth, and Kiriath Jearim.

17 So the Israelites set out and on the third day came to their cities: Gibeon, Kephirah, Beeroth and Kiriath Jearim.

18 But the People of Israel didn't attack them; the leaders of the congregation had given their word before the GOD of Israel. But the congregation was up in arms over their leaders.

18 But the Israelites did not attack them, because the leaders of the assembly had sworn an oath to them by the LORD, the God of Israel. The whole assembly grumbled against the leaders,

- 19 The leaders were united in their response to the congregation: "We promised them in the presence of the GOD of Israel. We can't lay a hand on them now.
- 19 but all the leaders answered, "We have given them our oath by the LORD, the God of Israel, and we cannot touch them now.
- 20 But we can do this: We will let them live so we don't get blamed for breaking our promise."
- 20 This is what we will do to them: We will let them live, so that wrath will not fall on us for breaking the oath we swore to them."
- 21 Then the leaders continued, "We'll let them live, but they will be woodcutters and water carriers for the entire congregation." And that's what happened; the leaders' promise was kept.
- 21 They continued, "Let them live, but let them be woodcutters and water carriers for the entire community." So the leaders' promise to them was kept.
- 22 But Joshua called the Gibeonites together and said, "Why did you lie to us, telling us, 'We live far, far away from you,' when you're our next-door neighbors?
- 22 Then Joshua summoned the Gibeonites and said, "Why did you deceive us by saying, 'We live a long way from you,' while actually you live near us?
- 23 For that you are cursed. From now on it's menial labor for you-- woodcutters and water carriers for the house of my God."
- 23 You are now under a curse: You will never cease to serve as woodcutters and water carriers for the house of my God."
- 24 They answered Joshua, "We got the message loud and clear that GOD, your God, commanded through his servant Moses: to give you the whole country and destroy everyone living in it. We were terrified because of you; that's why we did this.
- 24 They answered Joshua, "Your servants were clearly told how the LORD your God had commanded his servant Moses to give you the whole land and to wipe out all its inhabitants from before you. So we feared for our lives because of you, and that is why we did this.
- 25 That's it. We're at your mercy. Whatever you decide is right for us, do it."

- 25 We are now in your hands. Do to us whatever seems good and right to you."
- 26 And that's what they did. Joshua delivered them from the power of the People of Israel so they didn't kill them.
- 26 So Joshua saved them from the Israelites, and they did not kill them.
- 27 But he made them woodcutters and water carriers for the congregation and for the Altar of GOD at the place GOD chooses. They still are.
- 27 That day he made the Gibeonites woodcutters and water carriers for the community and for the altar of the LORD at the place the LORD would choose. And that is what they are to this day.

Joshua 10

MSG

NIV

- 1 It wasn't long before My-Master-Zedek king of Jerusalem heard that Joshua had taken Ai and destroyed it and its king under a holy curse, just as he had done to Jericho and its king. He also learned that the people of Gibeon had come to terms with Israel and were living as neighbors.
- 1 Now Adoni-Zedek king of Jerusalem heard that Joshua had taken Ai and totally destroyed it, doing to Ai and its king as he had done to Jericho and its king, and that the people of Gibeon had made a treaty of peace with Israel and were living near them.
- 2 He and his people were alarmed: Gibeon was a big city--as big as any with a king and bigger than Ai--and all its men were seasoned fighters.
- 2 He and his people were very much alarmed at this, because Gibeon was an important city, like one of the royal cities; it was larger than Ai, and all its men were good fighters.
- 3 Adoni-Zedek king of Jerusalem sent word to Hoham king of Hebron, Piram king of Jarmuth, Japhia king of Lachish, and Debir king of Eglon:
- 3 So Adoni-Zedek king of Jerusalem appealed to Hoham king of Hebron, Piram king of Jarmuth, Japhia king of Lachish and Debir king of Eglon.
- 4 "Come and help me. Let's attack Gibeon; they've joined up with Joshua and the People of Israel."
- 4 Come up and help me attack Gibeon, he said, "because it has made peace with Joshua and the Israelites."

- 5 So the five Amorite (Western) kings--the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon--combined their armies and set out to attack Gibeon.
- 5 Then the five kings of the Amorites--the kings of Jerusalem, Hebron, Jarmuth, Lachish and Eglon--joined forces. They moved up with all their troops and took up positions against Gibeon and attacked it.
- 6 The men of Gibeon sent word to Joshua camped at Gilgal, "Don't let us down now! Come up here quickly! Save us! Help us! All the Amorite kings who live up in the hills have ganged up on us."
- 6 The Gibeonites then sent word to Joshua in the camp at Gilgal: "Do not abandon your servants. Come up to us quickly and save us! Help us, because all the Amorite kings from the hill country have joined forces against us."
- 7 So Joshua set out from Gilgal, his whole army with him--all those tough soldiers!
- 7 So Joshua marched up from Gilgal with his entire army, including all the best fighting men.
- 8 GOD told him, "Don't give them a second thought. I've put them under your thumb--not one of them will stand up to you."
- 8 The LORD said to Joshua, "Do not be afraid of them; I have given them into your hand. Not one of them will be able to withstand you."
- 9 Joshua marched all night from Gilgal and took them by total surprise.
- 9 After an all-night march from Gilgal, Joshua took them by surprise.
- 10 GOD threw them into total confusion before Israel, a major victory at Gibeon. Israel chased them along the ridge to Beth Horon and fought them all the way down to Azekah and Makkedah.
- 10 The LORD threw them into confusion before Israel, who defeated them in a great victory at Gibeon. Israel pursued them along the road going up to Beth Horon and cut them down all the way to Azekah and Makkedah.
- 11 As they ran from the People of Israel, down from the Beth Horon ridge and all the way to Azekah, GOD pitched huge stones on them out of the sky and many died. More died from the hailstones than the People of Israel killed with the sword.
- 11 As they fled before Israel on the road down from Beth Horon to Azekah, the LORD hurled large hailstones down on them from the sky,

- and more of them died from the hailstones than were killed by the swords of the Israelites.
- 12 The day GOD gave the Amorites up to Israel, Joshua spoke to GOD, with all Israel listening: "Stop, Sun, over Gibeon; Halt, Moon, over Aijalon Valley."
- 12 On the day the LORD gave the Amorites over to Israel, Joshua said to the LORD in the presence of Israel: "O sun, stand still over Gibeon, O moon, over the Valley of Aijalon."
- 13 And Sun stopped, Moon stood stock still Until he defeated his enemies. (You can find this written in the Book of Jashar.) The sun stopped in its tracks in mid sky; just sat there all day.
- 13 So the sun stood still, and the moon stopped, till the nation avenged itself on its enemies, as it is written in the Book of Jashar. The sun stopped in the middle of the sky and delayed going down about a full day.
- 14 There's never been a day like that before or since--GOD took orders from a human voice! Truly, GOD fought for Israel.
- 14 There has never been a day like it before or since, a day when the LORD listened to a man. Surely the LORD was fighting for Israel!
- 15 Then Joshua returned, all Israel with him, to the camp at Gilgal.
- 15 Then Joshua returned with all Israel to the camp at Gilgal.
- 16 Meanwhile the five kings had hidden in the cave at Makkedah.
- 16 Now the five kings had fled and hidden in the cave at Makkedah.
- 17 Joshua was told, "The five kings have been found, hidden in the cave at Makkedah."
- 17 When Joshua was told that the five kings had been found hiding in the cave at Makkedah,
- 18 Joshua said, "Roll big stones against the mouth of the cave and post guards to keep watch.
- 18 he said, "Roll large rocks up to the mouth of the cave, and post some men there to guard it.
- 19 But don't you hang around--go after your enemies. Cut off their retreat. Don't let them back into their cities. GOD has given them to you."
- 19 But don't stop! Pursue your enemies, attack them from the rear and don't let them reach their cities, for the LORD your God has given them into your hand."

- 20 Joshua and the People of Israel then finished them off, total devastation. Only a few got away to the fortified towns.
- 20 So Joshua and the Israelites destroyed them completely-- almost to a man--but the few who were left reached their fortified cities.
- 21 The whole army then returned intact to the camp and to Joshua at Makkedah. There was no criticism that day from the People of Israel!
- 21 The whole army then returned safely to Joshua in the camp at Makkedah, and no one uttered a word against the Israelites.
- 22 Then Joshua said, "Open the mouth of the cave and bring me those five kings."
- 22 Joshua said, "Open the mouth of the cave and bring those five kings out to me."
- 23 They did it. They brought him the five kings from the cave: the king of Jerusalem, the king of Hebron, the king of Jarmuth, the king of Lachish, and the king of Eglon.
- 23 So they brought the five kings out of the cave--the kings of Jerusalem, Hebron, Jarmuth, Lachish and Eglon.
- 24 When they had them all there in front of Joshua, he called up the army and told the field commanders who had been with him, "Come here. Put your feet on the necks of these kings." They stepped up and put their feet on their necks.
- 24 When they had brought these kings to Joshua, he summoned all the men of Israel and said to the army commanders who had come with him, "Come here and put your feet on the necks of these kings." So they came forward and placed their feet on their necks.
- 25 Joshua told them, "Don't hold back. Don't be timid. Be strong! Be confident! This is what GOD will do to all your enemies when you fight them."
- 25 Joshua said to them, "Do not be afraid; do not be discouraged. Be strong and courageous. This is what the LORD will do to all the enemies you are going to fight."
- 26 Then Joshua struck and killed the kings. He hung them on five trees where they remained until evening.
- 26 Then Joshua struck and killed the kings and hung them on five trees, and they were left hanging on the trees until evening.

- 27 At sunset Joshua gave the command. They took them down from the trees and threw them into the cave where they had hidden. They put large stones at the mouth of the cave. The kings are still in there.
- 27 At sunset Joshua gave the order and they took them down from the trees and threw them into the cave where they had been hiding. At the mouth of the cave they placed large rocks, which are there to this day.
- 28 That same day Joshua captured Makkedah, a massacre that included the king. He carried out the holy curse. No survivors. Makkedah's king got the same treatment as Jericho's king.
- 28 That day Joshua took Makkedah. He put the city and its king to the sword and totally destroyed everyone in it. He left no survivors. And he did to the king of Makkedah as he had done to the king of Jericho.
- 29 Joshua, all Israel with him, moved on from Makkedah to Libnah and fought against Libnah.
- 29 Then Joshua and all Israel with him moved on from Makkedah to Libnah and attacked it.
- 30 GOD gave Libnah to Israel. They captured city and king and massacred the lot. No survivors. Libnah's king got the same treatment as Jericho's king.
- 30 The LORD also gave that city and its king into Israel's hand. The city and everyone in it Joshua put to the sword. He left no survivors there. And he did to its king as he had done to the king of Jericho.
- 31 Joshua, all Israel with him, moved on from Libnah to Lachish. He set up camp nearby and attacked.
- 31 Then Joshua and all Israel with him moved on from Libnah to Lachish; he took up positions against it and attacked it.
- 32 GOD gave Lachish to Israel. Israel took it in two days and killed everyone. He carried out the holy curse, the same as with Libnah.
- 32 The LORD handed Lachish over to Israel, and Joshua took it on the second day. The city and everyone in it he put to the sword, just as he had done to Libnah.
- 33 Horam, king of Gezer, arrived to help Lachish. Joshua attacked him and his army until there was nothing left of them. No survivors.
- 33 Meanwhile, Horam king of Gezer had come up to help Lachish, but Joshua defeated him and his army--until no survivors were left.

- 34 Joshua, all Israel with him, moved on from Lachish to Eglon. They set up camp and attacked.
- 34 Then Joshua and all Israel with him moved on from Lachish to Eglon; they took up positions against it and attacked it.
- 35 They captured it and killed everyone, carrying out the holy curse, the same as they had done with Lachish.
- 35 They captured it that same day and put it to the sword and totally destroyed everyone in it, just as they had done to Lachish.
- 36 Joshua, all Israel with him, went up from Eglon to Hebron. He attacked
- 36 Then Joshua and all Israel with him went up from Eglon to Hebron and attacked it.
- 37 and captured it. They killed everyone, including its king, its villages, and their people. No survivors, the same as with Eglon. They carried out the holy curse on city and people.
- 37 They took the city and put it to the sword, together with its king, its villages and everyone in it. They left no survivors. Just as at Eglon, they totally destroyed it and everyone in it.
- 38 Then Joshua, all Israel with him, turned toward Debir and attacked it.
- 38 Then Joshua and all Israel with him turned around and attacked Debir.
- 39 He captured it, its king, and its villages. They killed everyone. They put everyone and everything under the holy curse. No survivors. Debir and its king got the same treatment as Hebron and its king, and Libnah and its king.
- 39 They took the city, its king and its villages, and put them to the sword. Everyone in it they totally destroyed. They left no survivors. They did to Debir and its king as they had done to Libnah and its king and to Hebron.
- 40 Joshua took the whole country: hills, desert, foothills, and mountain slopes, including all kings. He left no survivors. He carried out the holy curse on everything that breathed, just as GOD, the God of Israel, had commanded.
- 40 So Joshua subdued the whole region, including the hill country, the Negev, the western foothills and the mountain slopes, together with all their kings. He left no survivors. He totally destroyed all who breathed, just as the LORD, the God of Israel, had commanded.

- 41 Joshua's conquest stretched from Kadesh Barnea to Gaza and from the entire region of Goshen to Gibeon.
- 41 Joshua subdued them from Kadesh Barnea to Gaza and from the whole region of Goshen to Gibeon.
- 42 Joshua took all these kings and their lands in a single campaign because GOD, the God of Israel, fought for Israel.
- 42 All these kings and their lands Joshua conquered in one campaign, because the LORD, the God of Israel, fought for Israel.
- 43 Then Joshua, all Israel with him, went back to the camp at Gilgal.
- 43 Then Joshua returned with all Israel to the camp at Gilgal.

Joshua 11

MSG

NIV

- 1 When Jabin king of Hazor heard of all this, he sent word to Jobab king of Madon; to the king of Shimron; to the king of Acshaph;
- 1 When Jabin king of Hazor heard of this, he sent word to Jobab king of Madon, to the kings of Shimron and Acshaph,
- 2 to all the kings in the northern mountains; to the kings in the valley south of Kinnereth; to the kings in the western foothills and Naphoth Dor;
- 2 and to the northern kings who were in the mountains, in the Arabah south of Kinnereth, in the western foothills and in Naphoth Dor on the west;
- 3 to the Canaanites both east and west; to the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites, and Jebusites in the hill country; and to the Hivites below Hermon in the region of Mizpah.
- 3 to the Canaanites in the east and west; to the Amorites, Hittites, Perizzites and Jebusites in the hill country; and to the Hivites below Hermon in the region of Mizpah.
- 4 They came out in full force, all their troops massed together--a huge army, in number like sand on an ocean beach--to say nothing of all the horses and chariots.
- 4 They came out with all their troops and a large number of horses and chariots--a huge army, as numerous as the sand on the seashore.
- 5 All these kings met and set up camp together at the Waters of Merom, ready to fight against Israel.

- 5 All these kings joined forces and made camp together at the Waters of Merom, to fight against Israel.
- 6 GOD said to Joshua: "Don't worry about them. This time tomorrow I'll hand them over to Israel, all dead. You'll hamstring their horses. You'll set fire to their chariots."
- 6 The LORD said to Joshua, "Do not be afraid of them, because by this time tomorrow I will hand all of them over to Israel, slain. You are to hamstring their horses and burn their chariots."
- 7 Joshua, his entire army with him, took them by surprise, falling on them at the Waters of Merom.
- 7 So Joshua and his whole army came against them suddenly at the Waters of Merom and attacked them,
- 8 GOD gave them to Israel, who struck and chased them all the way to Greater Sidon, to Misrephoth Maim, and then to the Valley of Mizpah on the east. No survivors.
- 8 and the LORD gave them into the hand of Israel. They defeated them and pursued them all the way to Greater Sidon, to Misrephoth Maim, and to the Valley of Mizpah on the east, until no survivors were left.
- 9 Joshua treated them following GOD's instructions: he hamstrung their horses; he burned up their chariots.
- 9 Joshua did to them as the LORD had directed: He hamstrung their horses and burned their chariots.
- 10 Then Joshua came back and took Hazor, killing its king. Early on Hazor had been head of all these kingdoms.
- 10 At that time Joshua turned back and captured Hazor and put its king to the sword. (Hazor had been the head of all these kingdoms.)
- 11 They killed every person there, carrying out the holy curse--not a breath of life left anywhere. Then he burned down Hazor.
- 11 Everyone in it they put to the sword. They totally destroyed them, not sparing anything that breathed, and he burned up Hazor itself.
- 12 Joshua captured and massacred all the royal towns with their kings, the holy curse commanded by Moses the servant of GOD.
- 12 Joshua took all these royal cities and their kings and put them to the sword. He totally destroyed them, as Moses the servant of the LORD had commanded.

- 13 But Israel didn't burn the cities that were built on mounds, except for Hazor--Joshua did burn down Hazor.
- 13 Yet Israel did not burn any of the cities built on their mounds--except Hazor, which Joshua burned.
- 14 The People of Israel plundered all the loot, including the cattle, from these towns for themselves. But they killed the people--total destruction. They left nothing human that breathed.
- 14 The Israelites carried off for themselves all the plunder and livestock of these cities, but all the people they put to the sword until they completely destroyed them, not sparing anyone that breathed.
- 15 Just as GOD commanded his servant Moses, so Moses commanded Joshua, and Joshua did it. He didn't leave incomplete one thing that GOD had commanded Moses.
- 15 As the LORD commanded his servant Moses, so Moses commanded Joshua, and Joshua did it; he left nothing undone of all that the LORD commanded Moses.
- 16 Joshua took the whole country: the mountains, the southern desert, all of Goshen, the foothills, the valley (the Arabah), and the Israel mountains with their foothills,
- 16 So Joshua took this entire land: the hill country, all the Negev, the whole region of Goshen, the western foothills, the Arabah and the mountains of Israel with their foothills,
- 17 from Mount Halak, which towers over the region of Seir, all the way to Baal Gad in the Valley of Lebanon in the shadows of Mount Hermon. He captured their kings and then killed them.
- 17 from Mount Halak, which rises toward Seir, to Baal Gad in the Valley of Lebanon below Mount Hermon. He captured all their kings and struck them down, putting them to death.
- 18 Joshua fought against these kings for a long time.
- 18 Joshua waged war against all these kings for a long time.
- 19 Not one town made peace with the People of Israel, with the one exception of the Hivites who lived in Gibeon. Israel fought and took all the rest.
- 19 Except for the Hivites living in Gibeon, not one city made a treaty of peace with the Israelites, who took them all in battle.

- 20 It was GOD's idea that they all would stubbornly fight the Israelites so he could put them under the holy curse without mercy. That way he could destroy them just as GOD had commanded Moses.
- 20 For it was the LORD himself who hardened their hearts to wage war against Israel, so that he might destroy them totally, exterminating them without mercy, as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 21 Joshua came out at that time also to root out the Anakim from the hills, from Hebron, from Debir, from Anab, from the mountains of Judah, from the mountains of Israel. Joshua carried out the holy curse on them and their cities.
- 21 At that time Joshua went and destroyed the Anakites from the hill country: from Hebron, Debir and Anab, from all the hill country of Judah, and from all the hill country of Israel. Joshua totally destroyed them and their towns.
- 22 No Anakim were left in the land of the People of Israel, except in Gaza, Gath, and Ashdod--there were a few left there.
- 22 No Anakites were left in Israelite territory; only in Gaza, Gath and Ashdod did any survive.
- 23 Joshua took the whole region. He did everything that GOD had told Moses. Then he parceled it out as an inheritance to Israel according to their tribes. And Israel had rest from war.
- 23 So Joshua took the entire land, just as the LORD had directed Moses, and he gave it as an inheritance to Israel according to their tribal divisions. Then the land had rest from war.

Joshua 12

MSG

NIV

- 1 These are the kings that the People of Israel defeated and whose land they took on the east of the Jordan, from the Arnon Gorge to Mount Hermon, with the whole eastern side of the Arabah Valley.
- 1 These are the kings of the land whom the Israelites had defeated and whose territory they took over east of the Jordan, from the Arnon Gorge to Mount Hermon, including all the eastern side of the Arabah:

- 2 Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned from Heshbon: His rule extended from Aroer, which sits at the edge of the Arnon Gorge, from the middle of the gorge and over half of Gilead to the Gorge of the Jabbok River, which is the border of the Ammonites.
- 2 Sihon king of the Amorites, who reigned in Heshbon. He ruled from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Gorge--from the middle of the gorge--to the Jabbok River, which is the border of the Ammonites. This included half of Gilead.
- 3 His rule included the eastern Arabah Valley from the Sea of Kinnereth to the Arabah Sea (the Salt Sea), eastward toward Beth Jeshimoth and southward to the slopes of Pisgah.
- 3 He also ruled over the eastern Arabah from the Sea of Kinnereth to the Sea of the Arabah (the Salt Sea), to Beth Jeshimoth, and then southward below the slopes of Pisgah.
- 4 And Og king of Bashan, one of the last of the Rephaim who reigned from Ashtaroth and Edrei:
- 4 And the territory of Og king of Bashan, one of the last of the Rephaites, who reigned in Ashtaroth and Edrei.
- 5 His rule extended from Mount Hermon and Salecah over the whole of Bashan to the border of the Geshurites and the Maacathites (the other half of Gilead) to the border of Sihon king of Heshbon.
- 5 He ruled over Mount Hermon, Salecah, all of Bashan to the border of the people of Geshur and Maacah, and half of Gilead to the border of Sihon king of Heshbon.
- 6 Moses the servant of GOD and the People of Israel defeated them. And Moses the servant of GOD gave this land as an inheritance to the Reubenites, the Gadites, and half of the tribe of Manasseh.
- 6 Moses, the servant of the LORD, and the Israelites conquered them. And Moses the servant of the LORD gave their land to the Reubenites, the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh to be their possession.
- 7 And these are the kings of the land that Joshua and the People of Israel defeated in the country west of the Jordan, from Baal Gad in the Valley of Lebanon south to Mount Halak, which towers over Seir. Joshua gave this land to the tribes of Israel as a possession, according to their divisions:

- 7 These are the kings of the land that Joshua and the Israelites conquered on the west side of the Jordan, from Baal Gad in the Valley of Lebanon to Mount Halak, which rises toward Seir (their lands Joshua gave as an inheritance to the tribes of Israel according to their tribal divisions--
- 8 lands in the mountains, the western foothills, and the Arabah Valley, on the slopes, and in the wilderness and the Negev desert (lands on which Hittites, Amorites and Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites, and Jebusites had lived). The kings were:
- 8 the hill country, the western foothills, the Arabah, the mountain slopes, the desert and the Negev--the lands of the Hittites, Amorites, Canaanites, Perizzites, Hivites and Jebusites):
- 9 The king of Jericho, one; The king of Ai (near Bethel), one;
- 9 the king of Jericho one the king of Ai (near Bethel) one
- 10 The king of Jerusalem, one; The king of Hebron, one;
- 10 the king of Jerusalem one the king of Hebron one
- 11 The king of Jarmuth, one; The king of Lachish, one;
- 11 the king of Jarmuth one the king of Lachish one
- 12 The king of Eglon, one; The king of Gezer, one;
- 12 the king of Eglon one the king of Gezer one
- 13 The king of Debir, one; The king of Geder, one;
- 13 the king of Debir one the king of Geder one
- 14 The king of Hormah, one; The king of Arad, one;
- 14 the king of Hormah one the king of Arad one
- 15 The king of Libnah, one; The king of Adullam, one;
- 15 the king of Libnah one the king of Adullam one
- 16 The king of Makkedah, one; The king of Bethel, one;
- 16 the king of Makkedah one the king of Bethel one
- 17 The king of Tappuah, one; The king of Hepher, one;
- 17 the king of Tappuah one the king of Hepher one
- 18 The king of Aphek, one; The king of Lasharon, one;
- 18 the king of Aphek one the king of Lasharon one
- 19 The king of Madon, one; The king of Hazor, one;
- 19 the king of Madon one the king of Hazor one
- 20 The king of Shimron Meron, one; The king of Acshaph, one;
- 20 the king of Shimron Meron one the king of Acshaph one
- 21 The king of Taanach, one; The king of Megiddo, one;

- 21 the king of Taanach one the king of Megiddo one
22 The king of Kedesh, one; The king of Jokneam in Carmel, one;
22 the king of Kedesh one the king of Jokneam in Carmel one
23 The king of Dor (Naphoth Dor), one; The king of Goyim in Gilgal, one;
23 the king of Dor (in Naphoth Dor) one the king of Goyim in Gilgal one
24 The king of Tirzah, one: A total of thirty-one kings.
24 the king of Tirzah one thirty-one kings in all.

Joshua 13

MSG

NIV

- 1 When Joshua had reached a venerable age, GOD said to him, "You've had a good, long life, but there is a lot of land still to be taken.
- 1 When Joshua was old and well advanced in years, the LORD said to him, "You are very old, and there are still very large areas of land to be taken over.
- 2 This is the land that remains: all the districts of the Philistines and Geshurites;
- 2 This is the land that remains: all the regions of the Philistines and Geshurites:
- 3 the land from the Shihor River east of Egypt to the border of Ekron up north, Canaanite country (there were five Philistine tyrants--in Gaza, in Ashdod, in Ashkelon, in Gath, in Ekron); also the Avvim
- 3 from the Shihor River on the east of Egypt to the territory of Ekron on the north, all of it counted as Canaanite (the territory of the five Philistine rulers in Gaza, Ashdod, Ashkelon, Gath and Ekron--that of the Avvites);
- 4 from the south; all the Canaanite land from Arah (belonging to the Sidonians) to Aphek at the Amorite border;
- 4 from the south, all the land of the Canaanites, from Arah of the Sidonians as far as Aphek, the region of the Amorites,
- 5 the country of the Gebalites; all Lebanon eastward from Baal Gad in the shadow of Mount Hermon to the Entrance of Hamath;
- 5 the area of the Gebalites; and all Lebanon to the east, from Baal Gad below Mount Hermon to Lebo Hamath.

- 6 all who live in the mountains, from Lebanon to Misrephoth Maim; all the Sidonians. "I myself will drive them out before the People of Israel. All you have to do is allot this land to Israel as an inheritance, as I have instructed you.
- 6 As for all the inhabitants of the mountain regions from Lebanon to Misrephoth Maim, that is, all the Sidonians, I myself will drive them out before the Israelites. Be sure to allocate this land to Israel for an inheritance, as I have instructed you,
- 7 Do it now: Allot this land as an inheritance to the nine tribes and the half-tribe of Manasseh."
- 7 and divide it as an inheritance among the nine tribes and half of the tribe of Manasseh."
- 8 The other half-tribe of Manasseh, with the Reubenites and Gadites, had been given their inheritance by Moses on the other side of the Jordan eastward. Moses the servant of GOD gave it to them.
- 8 The other half of Manasseh, the Reubenites and the Gadites had received the inheritance that Moses had given them east of the Jordan, as he, the servant of the LORD, had assigned it to them.
- 9 This land extended from Aroer at the edge of the Arnon Gorge and the city in the middle of the valley, taking in the entire tableland of Medeba as far as Dibon,
- 9 It extended from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Gorge, and from the town in the middle of the gorge, and included the whole plateau of Medeba as far as Dibon,
- 10 and all the towns of Sihon king of the Amorites, who ruled from Heshbon, and out to the border of the Ammonites.
- 10 and all the towns of Sihon king of the Amorites, who ruled in Heshbon, out to the border of the Ammonites.
- 11 It also included Gilead, the country of the people of Geshur and Maacah, all of Mount Hermon, and all Bashan as far as Salecah--
- 11 It also included Gilead, the territory of the people of Geshur and Maacah, all of Mount Hermon and all Bashan as far as Salecah--
- 12 the whole kingdom of Og in Bashan, who reigned in Ashtaroth and Edrei. He was one of the last survivors of the Rephaim. Moses had defeated them and taken their land.

- 12 that is, the whole kingdom of Og in Bashan, who had reigned in Ashtaroth and Edrei and had survived as one of the last of the Rephaites. Moses had defeated them and taken over their land.
- 13 The People of Israel never did drive out the Geshurites and the Maacathites--they're still there, living in Israel.
- 13 But the Israelites did not drive out the people of Geshur and Maacah, so they continue to live among the Israelites to this day.
- 14 Levi was the only tribe that did not receive an inheritance. The Fire-Gift offerings to GOD, the God of Israel, are their inheritance, just as he told them.
- 14 But to the tribe of Levi he gave no inheritance, since the offerings made by fire to the LORD, the God of Israel, are their inheritance, as he promised them.
- 15 To the tribe of Reuben, clan by clan, Moses gave:
- 15 This is what Moses had given to the tribe of Reuben, clan by clan:
- 16 the land from Aroer at the edge of the Arnon Gorge and the town in the middle of the valley, including the tableland around Medeba;
- 16 The territory from Aroer on the rim of the Arnon Gorge, and from the town in the middle of the gorge, and the whole plateau past Medeba
- 17 Heshbon on the tableland with all its towns (Dibon, Bamoth Baal, Beth Baal Meon,
- 17 to Heshbon and all its towns on the plateau, including Dibon, Bamoth Baal, Beth Baal Meon,
- 18 Jahaz, Kedemoth, Mephaath,
- 18 Jahaz, Kedemoth, Mephaath,
- 19 Kiriathaim, Sibmah, Zereth Shahar on Valley Mountain,
- 19 Kiriathaim, Sibmah, Zereth Shahar on the hill in the valley,
- 20 Beth Peor, the slopes of Pisgah, Beth Jeshimoth);
- 20 Beth Peor, the slopes of Pisgah, and Beth Jeshimoth
- 21 and all the cities of the tableland, the whole kingdom of Sihon king of the Amorites, who ruled at Heshbon, whom Moses put to death along with the princes of Midian: Evi, Rekem, Zur, Hur, and Reba, who lived in that country, all puppets of Sihon.
- 21 #NAME?
- 22 (In addition to those killed in battle, Balaam son of Beor, the soothsayer, was put to death by the People of Israel.)

- 22 In addition to those slain in battle, the Israelites had put to the sword Balaam son of Beor, who practiced divination.
- 23 The boundary for the Reubenites was the bank of the Jordan River. This was the inheritance of the Reubenites, their villages and cities, according to their clans.
- 23 The boundary of the Reubenites was the bank of the Jordan. These towns and their villages were the inheritance of the Reubenites, clan by clan.
- 24 To the tribe of Gad, clan by clan, Moses gave:
- 24 This is what Moses had given to the tribe of Gad, clan by clan:
- 25 the territory of Jazer and all the towns of Gilead and half the Ammonite country as far as Aroer near Rabbah;
- 25 The territory of Jazer, all the towns of Gilead and half the Ammonite country as far as Aroer, near Rabbah;
- 26 the land from Heshbon to Ramath Mizpah and Betonim, and from Mahanaim to the region of Debir;
- 26 and from Heshbon to Ramath Mizpah and Betonim, and from Mahanaim to the territory of Debir;
- 27 in the valley: Beth Haram, Beth Nimrah, Succoth, and Zaphon, with the rest of the kingdom of Sihon king of Heshbon (the east side of the Jordan, north to the end of the Sea of Kinnereth).
- 27 and in the valley, Beth Haram, Beth Nimrah, Succoth and Zaphon with the rest of the realm of Sihon king of Heshbon (the east side of the Jordan, the territory up to the end of the Sea of Kinnereth).
- 28 This was the inheritance of the Gadites, their cities and villages, clan by clan.
- 28 These towns and their villages were the inheritance of the Gadites, clan by clan.
- 29 To the half-tribe of Manasseh, clan by clan, Moses gave:
- 29 This is what Moses had given to the half-tribe of Manasseh, that is, to half the family of the descendants of Manasseh, clan by clan:
- 30 the land stretching out from Mahanaim; all of Bashan, which is the entire kingdom of Og king of Bashan, and all the settlements of Jair in Bashan--sixty towns in all.
- 30 The territory extending from Mahanaim and including all of Bashan, the entire realm of Og king of Bashan--all the settlements of Jair in Bashan,

sixty towns,

- 31 Half of Gilead with Ashtaroth and Edrei, the royal cities of Og in Bashan, belong to the descendants of Makir, a son of Manasseh (in other words, the half-tribe of the children of Makir) for their clans.
- 31 half of Gilead, and Ashtaroth and Edrei (the royal cities of Og in Bashan). This was for the descendants of Makir son of Manasseh--for half of the sons of Makir, clan by clan.
- 32 This is the inheritance that Moses gave out when he was on the plains of Moab across the Jordan east of Jericho.
- 32 This is the inheritance Moses had given when he was in the plains of Moab across the Jordan east of Jericho.
- 33 But Moses gave no inheritance to the tribe of Levi. GOD, the God of Israel, is their inheritance, just as he told them.
- 33 But to the tribe of Levi, Moses had given no inheritance; the LORD, the God of Israel, is their inheritance, as he promised them.

Joshua 14

MSG

NIV

- 1 Here are the inheritance allotments that the People of Israel received in the land of Canaan. Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun, and the heads of the family clans made the allotments.
- 1 Now these are the areas the Israelites received as an inheritance in the land of Canaan, which Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun and the heads of the tribal clans of Israel allotted to them.
- 2 Each inheritance was assigned by lot to the nine and a half tribes, just as GOD had commanded Moses.
- 2 Their inheritances were assigned by lot to the nine-and-a-half tribes, as the LORD had commanded through Moses.
- 3 Moses had given the two and a half tribes their inheritance east of the Jordan, but hadn't given an inheritance to the Levites, as he had to the others.
- 3 Moses had granted the two-and-a-half tribes their inheritance east of the Jordan but had not granted the Levites an inheritance among the rest,

- 4 Because the sons of Joseph had become two tribes, Manasseh and Ephraim, they gave no allotment to the Levites; but they did give them cities to live in with pasture rights for their flocks and herds.
- 4 for the sons of Joseph had become two tribes--Manasseh and Ephraim. The Levites received no share of the land but only towns to live in, with pasturelands for their flocks and herds.
- 5 The People of Israel followed through exactly as GOD had commanded Moses. They apportioned the land.
- 5 So the Israelites divided the land, just as the LORD had commanded Moses.
- 6 The people of Judah came to Joshua at Gilgal. Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite spoke: "You'll remember what GOD said to Moses the man of God concerning you and me back at Kadesh Barnea.
- 6 Now the men of Judah approached Joshua at Gilgal, and Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite said to him, "You know what the LORD said to Moses the man of God at Kadesh Barnea about you and me.
- 7 I was forty years old when Moses the servant of GOD sent me from Kadesh Barnea to spy out the land. And I brought back an honest and accurate report.
- 7 I was forty years old when Moses the servant of the LORD sent me from Kadesh Barnea to explore the land. And I brought him back a report according to my convictions,
- 8 My companions who went with me discouraged the people, but I stuck to my guns, totally with GOD, my God.
- 8 but my brothers who went up with me made the hearts of the people melt with fear. I, however, followed the LORD my God wholeheartedly.
- 9 That was the day that Moses solemnly promised, 'The land on which your feet have walked will be your inheritance, you and your children's, forever. Yes, you have lived totally for GOD.'
- 9 So on that day Moses swore to me, 'The land on which your feet have walked will be your inheritance and that of your children forever, because you have followed the LORD my God wholeheartedly.'
- 10 Now look at me: GOD has kept me alive, as he promised. It is now forty-five years since GOD spoke this word to Moses, years in which Israel wandered in the wilderness. And here I am today, eighty-five years old!

- 10 Now then, just as the LORD promised, he has kept me alive for forty-five years since the time he said this to Moses, while Israel moved about in the desert. So here I am today, eighty-five years old!
- 11 I'm as strong as I was the day Moses sent me out. I'm as strong as ever in battle, whether coming or going.
- 11 I am still as strong today as the day Moses sent me out; I'm just as vigorous to go out to battle now as I was then.
- 12 So give me this hill country that GOD promised me. You yourself heard the report, that the Anakim were there with their great fortress cities. If GOD goes with me, I will drive them out, just as GOD said."
- 12 Now give me this hill country that the LORD promised me that day. You yourself heard then that the Anakites were there and their cities were large and fortified, but, the LORD helping me, I will drive them out just as he said."
- 13 Joshua blessed him. He gave Hebron to Caleb son of Jephunneh as an inheritance.
- 13 Then Joshua blessed Caleb son of Jephunneh and gave him Hebron as his inheritance.
- 14 Hebron belongs to Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite still today, because he gave himself totally to GOD, the God of Israel.
- 14 So Hebron has belonged to Caleb son of Jephunneh the Kenizzite ever since, because he followed the LORD, the God of Israel, wholeheartedly.
- 15 The name of Hebron used to be Kiriath Arba, named after Arba, the greatest man among the Anakim. And the land had rest from war.
- 15 (Hebron used to be called Kiriath Arba after Arba, who was the greatest man among the Anakites.) Then the land had rest from war.

Joshua 15

MSG

NIV

- 1 The lot for the people of Judah, their clans, extended south to the border of Edom, to the wilderness of Zin in the extreme south.
- 1 The allotment for the tribe of Judah, clan by clan, extended down to the territory of Edom, to the Desert of Zin in the extreme south.
- 2 The southern border ran from the tip of the Salt Sea south of The Tongue;

- 2 Their southern boundary started from the bay at the southern end of the Salt Sea,
- 3 it ran southward from Scorpions Pass, went around Zin and just south of Kadesh Barnea; then it ran past Hezron, ascended to Addar, and curved around to Karka;
- 3 crossed south of Scorpion Pass, continued on to Zin and went over to the south of Kadesh Barnea. Then it ran past Hezron up to Addar and curved around to Karka.
- 4 from there it passed along to Azmon, came out at the Brook of Egypt, ending at the Sea. This is the southern boundary.
- 4 It then passed along to Azmon and joined the Wadi of Egypt, ending at the sea. This is their southern boundary.
- 5 The eastern boundary: the Salt Sea up to the mouth of the Jordan. The northern boundary started at the shallows of the Sea at the mouth of the Jordan,
- 5 The eastern boundary is the Salt Sea as far as the mouth of the Jordan. The northern boundary started from the bay of the sea at the mouth of the Jordan,
- 6 went up to Beth Hoglah and around to the north of Beth Arabah and to the Stone of Bohan son of Reuben.
- 6 went up to Beth Hoglah and continued north of Beth Arabah to the Stone of Bohan son of Reuben.
- 7 The border then ascended to Debir from Trouble Valley and turned north toward Gilgal, which lies opposite Red Pass, just south of the gorge. The border then followed the Waters of En Shemesh and ended at En Rogel.
- 7 The boundary then went up to Debir from the Valley of Achor and turned north to Gilgal, which faces the Pass of Adummim south of the gorge. It continued along to the waters of En Shemesh and came out at En Rogel.
- 8 The border followed the Valley of Ben Hinnom along the southern slope of the Jebusite ridge (that is, Jerusalem). It ascended to the top of the mountain opposite Hinnom Valley on the west, at the northern end of Rephaim Valley;
- 8 Then it ran up the Valley of Ben Hinnom along the southern slope of the Jebusite city (that is, Jerusalem). From there it climbed to the top of the hill west of the Hinnom Valley at the northern end of the Valley of Rephaim.

- 9 the border then took a turn at the top of the mountain to the spring, the Waters of Nephtoah, and followed the valley out to Mount Ephron, turned toward Baalah (that is, Kiriath Jearim),
- 9 From the hilltop the boundary headed toward the spring of the waters of Nephtoah, came out at the towns of Mount Ephron and went down toward Baalah (that is, Kiriath Jearim).
- 10 took another turn west of Baalah to Mount Seir, curved around to the northern shoulder of Mount Jearim (that is, Kesalon), descended to Beth Shemesh, and crossed to Timnah.
- 10 Then it curved westward from Baalah to Mount Seir, ran along the northern slope of Mount Jearim (that is, Kesalon), continued down to Beth Shemesh and crossed to Timnah.
- 11 The border then went north to the ridge of Ekron, turned toward Shikkeron, passed along to Mount Baalah, and came out at Jabneel. The border ended at the Sea.
- 11 It went to the northern slope of Ekron, turned toward Shikkeron, passed along to Mount Baalah and reached Jabneel. The boundary ended at the sea.
- 12 The western border: the coastline of the Great Sea. This is the boundary around the people of Judah for their clans.
- 12 The western boundary is the coastline of the Great Sea. These are the boundaries around the people of Judah by their clans.
- 13 Joshua gave Caleb son of Jephunneh a section among the people of Judah, according to GOD's command. He gave him Kiriath Arba, that is, Hebron. Arba was the ancestor of Anak.
- 13 In accordance with the LORD's command to him, Joshua gave to Caleb son of Jephunneh a portion in Judah--Kiriath Arba, that is, Hebron. (Arba was the forefather of Anak.)
- 14 Caleb drove out three Anakim from Hebron: Sheshai, Ahiman, and Talmai, all descendants of Anak.
- 14 From Hebron Caleb drove out the three Anakites--Sheshai, Ahiman and Talmai--descendants of Anak.
- 15 He marched up from there against the people of Debir. Debir used to be called Kiriath Sepher.
- 15 From there he marched against the people living in Debir (formerly called Kiriath Sepher).

- 16 Caleb said, "Whoever attacks Kiriath Sepher and takes it, I'll give my daughter Acsah to him as his wife."
- 16 And Caleb said, "I will give my daughter Acsah in marriage to the man who attacks and captures Kiriath Sepher."
- 17 Othniel son of Kenaz, Caleb's brother, took it; so Caleb gave him his daughter Acsah as his wife.
- 17 Othniel son of Kenaz, Caleb's brother, took it; so Caleb gave his daughter Acsah to him in marriage.
- 18 When she arrived she got him to ask for farm land from her father. As she dismounted from her donkey Caleb asked her, "What would you like?"
- 18 One day when she came to Othniel, she urged him to ask her father for a field. When she got off her donkey, Caleb asked her, "What can I do for you?"
- 19 She said, "Give me a marriage gift. You've given me desert land; Now give me pools of water!" And he gave her the upper and the lower pools.
- 19 She replied, "Do me a special favor. Since you have given me land in the Negev, give me also springs of water." So Caleb gave her the upper and lower springs.
- 20 This is the inheritance of the tribe of the people of Judah, clan by clan.
- 20 This is the inheritance of the tribe of Judah, clan by clan:
- 21 The southern towns of the tribe of Judah in the Negev were near the boundary of Edom: Kabzeel, Eder, Jagur,
- 21 The southernmost towns of the tribe of Judah in the Negev toward the boundary of Edom were: Kabzeel, Eder, Jagur,
- 22 Kinah, Dimonah, Adadah,
- 22 Kinah, Dimonah, Adadah,
- 23 Kedesh, Hazor, Ithnan,
- 23 Kedesh, Hazor, Ithnan,
- 24 Ziph, Telem, Bealoth,
- 24 Ziph, Telem, Bealoth,
- 25 Hazor Hadattah, Kerioth Hezron (that is, Hazor),
- 25 Hazor Hadattah, Kerioth Hezron (that is, Hazor),
- 26 Amam, Shema, Moladah,
- 26 Amam, Shema, Moladah,
- 27 Hazar Gaddah, Heshmon, Beth Pelet,

- 27 Hazar Gaddah, Heshmon, Beth Pelet,
28 Hazar Shual, Beersheba, Biziothiah,
28 Hazar Shual, Beersheba, Biziothiah,
29 Baalah, Iim, Ezem,
29 Baalah, Iim, Ezem,
30 Eltolad, Kesil, Hormah,
30 Eltolad, Kesil, Hormah,
31 Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah,
31 Ziklag, Madmannah, Sansannah,
32 Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain, and Rimmon-- a total of twenty-nine towns and their villages.
32 Lebaoth, Shilhim, Ain and Rimmon--a total of twenty-nine towns and their villages.
33 In the Shephelah (the western foothills) there were: Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah,
33 In the western foothills: Eshtaol, Zorah, Ashnah,
34 Zanoah, En Gannim, Tappuah, Enam,
34 Zanoah, En Gannim, Tappuah, Enam,
35 Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh, Azekah,
35 Jarmuth, Adullam, Socoh, Azekah,
36 Shaaraim, Adithaim, and Gederah (or Gederothaim)-- fourteen towns and their villages.
36 Shaaraim, Adithaim and Gederah (or Gederothaim)--fourteen towns and their villages.
37 Zenan, Hadashah, Migdal Gad,
37 Zenan, Hadashah, Migdal Gad,
38 Dilean, Mizpah, Joktheel,
38 Dilean, Mizpah, Joktheel,
39 Lachish, Bozkath, Eglon,
39 Lachish, Bozkath, Eglon,
40 Cabbon, Lahmas, Kitlish,
40 Cabbon, Lahmas, Kitlish,
41 Gederoth, Beth Dagon, Naamah, and Makkedah-- sixteen towns and their villages.
41 Gederoth, Beth Dagon, Naamah and Makkedah--sixteen towns and their villages.

42 Libnah, Ether, Ashan,
42 Libnah, Ether, Ashan,
43 Iphtah, Ashnah, Nezib,
43 Iphtah, Ashnah, Nezib,
44 Keilah, Aczib, and Mareshah-- nine towns and their villages.
44 Keilah, Aczib and Mareshah--nine towns and their villages.
45 Ekron with its towns and villages;
45 Ekron, with its surrounding settlements and villages;
46 From Ekron, west to the sea, all that bordered Ashdod with its villages;
46 west of Ekron, all that were in the vicinity of Ashdod, together with
their villages;
47 Ashdod with its towns and villages; Gaza with its towns and villages all
the way to the Brook of Egypt. The Great Sea is the western border.
47 Ashdod, its surrounding settlements and villages; and Gaza, its
settlements and villages, as far as the Wadi of Egypt and the coastline of
the Great Sea.
48 In the hill country: Shamir, Jattir, Socoh,
48 In the hill country: Shamir, Jattir, Socoh,
49 Dannah, Kiriath Sannah (that is, Debir),
49 Dannah, Kiriath Sannah (that is, Debir),
50 Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim,
50 Anab, Eshtemoh, Anim,
51 Goshen, Holon, and Giloh-- eleven towns and their villages.
51 Goshen, Holon and Giloh--eleven towns and their villages.
52 Arab, Dumah, Eshan,
52 Arab, Dumah, Eshan,
53 Janim, Beth Tappuah, Aphekah,
53 Janim, Beth Tappuah, Aphekah,
54 Humtah, Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron), and Zior-- nine towns and their
villages.
54 Humtah, Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron) and Zior--nine towns and their
villages.
55 Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Juttah,
55 Maon, Carmel, Ziph, Juttah,
56 Jezreel, Jokdeam, Zanoah,
56 Jezreel, Jokdeam, Zanoah,

- 57 Kain, Gibeah, and Timnah-- ten towns and their villages.
57 Kain, Gibeah and Timnah--ten towns and their villages.
58 Halhul, Beth Zur, Gedor,
58 Halhul, Beth Zur, Gedor,
59 Maarath, Beth Anoth, and Eltekon-- six towns and their villages.
59 Maarath, Beth Anoth and Eltekon--six towns and their villages.
60 Kiriath Baal (that is, Kiriath Jearim) and Rabbah-- two towns and their villages.
60 Kiriath Baal (that is, Kiriath Jearim) and Rabbah--two towns and their villages.
61 In the wilderness: Beth Arabah, Middin, Secacah,
61 In the desert: Beth Arabah, Middin, Secacah,
62 Nibshan, the City of Salt, and En Gedi-- six towns and their villages.
62 Nibshan, the City of Salt and En Gedi--six towns and their villages.
63 The people of Judah couldn't get rid of the Jebusites who lived in Jerusalem. The Jebusites stayed put, living alongside the people of Judah. They are still living there in Jerusalem.
63 Judah could not dislodge the Jebusites, who were living in Jerusalem; to this day the Jebusites live there with the people of Judah.

Joshua 16

MSG

NIV

- 1 The lot for the people of Joseph went from the Jordan near Jericho, east of the spring of Jericho, north through the desert mountains to Bethel.
1 The allotment for Joseph began at the Jordan of Jericho, east of the waters of Jericho, and went up from there through the desert into the hill country of Bethel.
2 It went on from Bethel (that is, Luz) to the territory of the Arkites in Ataroth.
2 It went on from Bethel (that is, Luz), crossed over to the territory of the Arkites in Ataroth,
3 It then descended westward to the territory of the Japhletites to the region of Lower Beth Horon and on to Gezer, ending at the Sea.

- 3 descended westward to the territory of the Japhletites as far as the region of Lower Beth Horon and on to Gezer, ending at the sea.
- 4 This is the region from which the people of Joseph--Manasseh and Ephraim--got their inheritance.
- 4 So Manasseh and Ephraim, the descendants of Joseph, received their inheritance.
- 5 Ephraim's territory by clans: The boundary of their inheritance went from Ataroth Addar in the east to Upper Beth Horon
- 5 This was the territory of Ephraim, clan by clan: The boundary of their inheritance went from Ataroth Addar in the east to Upper Beth Horon
- 6 and then west to the Sea. From Micmethath on the north it turned eastward to Taanath Shiloh and passed along, still eastward, to Janoah.
- 6 and continued to the sea. From Micmethath on the north it curved eastward to Taanath Shiloh, passing by it to Janoah on the east.
- 7 The border then descended from Janoah to Ataroth and Naarah; it touched Jericho and came out at the Jordan.
- 7 Then it went down from Janoah to Ataroth and Naarah, touched Jericho and came out at the Jordan.
- 8 From Tappuah the border went westward to the Brook Kanah and ended at the Sea. This was the inheritance of the tribe of Ephraim by clans,
- 8 From Tappuah the border went west to the Kanah Ravine and ended at the sea. This was the inheritance of the tribe of the Ephraimites, clan by clan.
- 9 including the cities set aside for Ephraim within the inheritance of Manasseh--all those towns and their villages.
- 9 It also included all the towns and their villages that were set aside for the Ephraimites within the inheritance of the Manassites.
- 10 But they didn't get rid of the Canaanites who were living in Gezer. Canaanites are still living among the people of Ephraim, but they are made to do forced labor.
- 10 They did not dislodge the Canaanites living in Gezer; to this day the Canaanites live among the people of Ephraim but are required to do forced labor.

Joshua 17

MSG

NIV

- 1 This is the lot that fell to the people of Manasseh, Joseph's firstborn. (Gilead and Bashan had already been given to Makir, Manasseh's firstborn and father of Gilead, because he was an outstanding fighter.)
- 1 This was the allotment for the tribe of Manasseh as Joseph's firstborn, that is, for Makir, Manasseh's firstborn. Makir was the ancestor of the Gileadites, who had received Gilead and Bashan because the Makirites were great soldiers.
- 2 So the lot that follows went to the rest of the people of Manasseh and their clans, the clans of Abiezer, Helek, Asriel, Shechem, Hepher, and Shemida. These are the male descendants of Manasseh son of Joseph by their clans.
- 2 So this allotment was for the rest of the people of Manasseh--the clans of Abiezer, Helek, Asriel, Shechem, Hepher and Shemida. These are the other male descendants of Manasseh son of Joseph by their clans.
- 3 Zelophehad son of Hepher, the son of Gilead, the son of Makir, the son of Manasseh, had no sons, only daughters. Their names were Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah, and Tirzah.
- 3 Now Zelophehad son of Hepher, the son of Gilead, the son of Makir, the son of Manasseh, had no sons but only daughters, whose names were Mahlah, Noah, Hoglah, Milcah and Tirzah.
- 4 They went to Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun, and the leaders and said, "GOD commanded Moses to give us an inheritance among our kinsmen." And Joshua did it; he gave them, as GOD commanded, an inheritance amid their father's brothers.
- 4 They went to Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun, and the leaders and said, "The LORD commanded Moses to give us an inheritance among our brothers." So Joshua gave them an inheritance along with the brothers of their father, according to the LORD's command.
- 5 Manasseh's lot came to ten portions, in addition to the land of Gilead and Bashan on the other side of the Jordan,
- 5 Manasseh's share consisted of ten tracts of land besides Gilead and Bashan east of the Jordan,
- 6 because Manasseh's daughters got an inheritance along with his sons. The land of Gilead belonged to the rest of the people of Manasseh.

- 6 because the daughters of the tribe of Manasseh received an inheritance among the sons. The land of Gilead belonged to the rest of the descendants of Manasseh.
- 7 The boundary of Manasseh went from Asher all the way to Micmethath, just opposite Shechem, then ran southward to the people living at En Tappuah.
- 7 The territory of Manasseh extended from Asher to Micmethath east of Shechem. The boundary ran southward from there to include the people living at En Tappuah.
- 8 (The land of Tappuah belonged to Manasseh, but Tappuah itself on the border of Manasseh belonged to the Ephraimites.)
- 8 (Manasseh had the land of Tappuah, but Tappuah itself, on the boundary of Manasseh, belonged to the Ephraimites.)
- 9 The boundary continued south to the Brook Kanah. (The cities there belonged to Ephraim although they lay among the cities of Manasseh.) The boundary of Manasseh ran north of the brook and ended at the Sea.
- 9 Then the boundary continued south to the Kanah Ravine. There were towns belonging to Ephraim lying among the towns of Manasseh, but the boundary of Manasseh was the northern side of the ravine and ended at the sea.
- 10 The land to the south belonged to Ephraim; the land to the north to Manasseh, with the Sea as their western border; they meet Asher on the north and Issachar on the east.
- 10 On the south the land belonged to Ephraim, on the north to Manasseh. The territory of Manasseh reached the sea and bordered Asher on the north and Issachar on the east.
- 11 Within Issachar and Asher, Manasseh also held Beth Shan, Ibleam, and the people of Dor, Endor, Taanach, and Megiddo, together with their villages, and the third in the list is Naphoth.
- 11 Within Issachar and Asher, Manasseh also had Beth Shan, Ibleam and the people of Dor, Endor, Taanach and Megiddo, together with their surrounding settlements (the third in the list is Naphoth).
- 12 The people of Manasseh never were able to take over these towns--the Canaanites wouldn't budge.
- 12 Yet the Manassites were not able to occupy these towns, for the Canaanites were determined to live in that region.

- 13 But later, when the Israelites got stronger, they put the Canaanites to forced labor. But they never did get rid of them.
- 13 However, when the Israelites grew stronger, they subjected the Canaanites to forced labor but did not drive them out completely.
- 14 The people of Joseph spoke to Joshua: "Why did you give us just one allotment, one solitary share? There are a lot of us, and growing--GOD has extravagantly blessed us."
- 14 The people of Joseph said to Joshua, "Why have you given us only one allotment and one portion for an inheritance? We are a numerous people and the LORD has blessed us abundantly."
- 15 Joshua responded, "Since there are so many of you, and you find the hill country of Ephraim too confining, climb into the forest and clear ground there for yourselves in the land of the Perizzites and the Rephaim."
- 15 If you are so numerous, Joshua answered, "and if the hill country of Ephraim is too small for you, go up into the forest and clear land for yourselves there in the land of the Perizzites and Rephaites."
- 16 But the people of Joseph said, "There's not enough hill country for us; and the Canaanites who live down in the plain, both those in Beth Shan and its villages and in the Valley of Jezreel, have iron chariots."
- 16 The people of Joseph replied, "The hill country is not enough for us, and all the Canaanites who live in the plain have iron chariots, both those in Beth Shan and its settlements and those in the Valley of Jezreel."
- 17 Joshua said to the family of Joseph (to Ephraim and Manasseh): "Yes, there are a lot of you, and you are very strong. One lot is not enough for you."
- 17 But Joshua said to the house of Joseph--to Ephraim and Manasseh-- "You are numerous and very powerful. You will have not only one allotment
- 18 You also get the hill country. It's nothing but trees now, but you will clear the land and make it your own from one end to the other. The powerful Canaanites, even with their iron chariots, won't stand a chance against you."
- 18 but the forested hill country as well. Clear it, and its farthest limits will be yours; though the Canaanites have iron chariots and though they are strong, you can drive them out."

Joshua 18

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then the entire congregation of the People of Israel got together at Shiloh. They put up the Tent of Meeting. The land was under their control
- 1 The whole assembly of the Israelites gathered at Shiloh and set up the Tent of Meeting there. The country was brought under their control,
- 2 but there were still seven Israelite tribes who had yet to receive their inheritance.
- 2 but there were still seven Israelite tribes who had not yet received their inheritance.
- 3 Joshua addressed the People of Israel: "How long are you going to sit around on your hands, putting off taking possession of the land that GOD, the God of your ancestors, has given you?
- 3 So Joshua said to the Israelites: "How long will you wait before you begin to take possession of the land that the LORD, the God of your fathers, has given you?
- 4 Pick three men from each tribe so I can commission them. They will survey and map the land, showing the inheritance due each tribe, and report back to me.
- 4 Appoint three men from each tribe. I will send them out to make a survey of the land and to write a description of it, according to the inheritance of each. Then they will return to me.
- 5 They will divide it into seven parts. Judah will stay in its territory in the south and the people of Joseph will keep to their place in the north.
- 5 You are to divide the land into seven parts. Judah is to remain in its territory on the south and the house of Joseph in its territory on the north.
- 6 "You are responsible for preparing a survey map showing seven portions. Then bring it to me so that I can cast lots for you here in the presence of our GOD.
- 6 After you have written descriptions of the seven parts of the land, bring them here to me and I will cast lots for you in the presence of the LORD our God.

- 7 "Only the Levites get no portion among you because the priesthood of GOD is their inheritance. And Gad, Reuben, and the half-tribe of Manasseh already have their inheritance on the east side of the Jordan, given to them by Moses the servant of GOD."
- 7 The Levites, however, do not get a portion among you, because the priestly service of the LORD is their inheritance. And Gad, Reuben and the half-tribe of Manasseh have already received their inheritance on the east side of the Jordan. Moses the servant of the LORD gave it to them."
- 8 So the men set out. As they went out to survey the land, Joshua charged them: "Go. Survey the land and map it. Then come back to me and I will cast lots for you here at Shiloh in the presence of GOD."
- 8 As the men started on their way to map out the land, Joshua instructed them, "Go and make a survey of the land and write a description of it. Then return to me, and I will cast lots for you here at Shiloh in the presence of the LORD."
- 9 So off the men went. They covered the ground and mapped the country by towns in a scroll. Then they reported back to Joshua at the camp at Shiloh.
- 9 So the men left and went through the land. They wrote its description on a scroll, town by town, in seven parts, and returned to Joshua in the camp at Shiloh.
- 10 Joshua cast the lots for them at Shiloh in the presence of GOD. That's where Joshua divided up the land to the People of Israel, according to their tribal divisions.
- 10 Joshua then cast lots for them in Shiloh in the presence of the LORD, and there he distributed the land to the Israelites according to their tribal divisions.
- 11 The first lot turned up for the tribe of Benjamin with its clans. The border of the allotment went between the peoples of Judah and Joseph.
- 11 The lot came up for the tribe of Benjamin, clan by clan. Their allotted territory lay between the tribes of Judah and Joseph:
- 12 The northern border began at the Jordan, then went up to the ridge north of Jericho, ascending west into the hill country into the wilderness of Beth Aven.
- 12 On the north side their boundary began at the Jordan, passed the northern slope of Jericho and headed west into the hill country, coming

out at the desert of Beth Aven.

- 13 From there the border went around to Luz, to its southern ridge (that is, Bethel), and then down from Ataroth Addar to the mountain to the south of Lower Beth Horon.
- 13 From there it crossed to the south slope of Luz (that is, Bethel) and went down to Ataroth Addar on the hill south of Lower Beth Horon.
- 14 There the border took a turn on the west side and swung south from the mountain to the south of Beth Horon and ended at Kiriath Baal (that is, Kiriath Jearim), a town of the people of Judah. This was the west side.
- 14 From the hill facing Beth Horon on the south the boundary turned south along the western side and came out at Kiriath Baal (that is, Kiriath Jearim), a town of the people of Judah. This was the western side.
- 15 The southern border began at the edge of Kiriath Jearim on the west, then ran west until it reached the spring, the Waters of Nephtoah.
- 15 The southern side began at the outskirts of Kiriath Jearim on the west, and the boundary came out at the spring of the waters of Nephtoah.
- 16 It then descended to the foot of the mountain opposite the Valley of Ben Hinnom (which flanks the Valley of Rephaim to the north), descended to the Hinnom Valley, just south of the Jebusite ridge, and went on to En Rogel.
- 16 The boundary went down to the foot of the hill facing the Valley of Ben Hinnom, north of the Valley of Rephaim. It continued down the Hinnom Valley along the southern slope of the Jebusite city and so to En Rogel.
- 17 From there it curved north to En Shemesh and Geliloth, opposite the Red Pass (Adummim), down to the Stone of Bohan the son of Reuben,
- 17 It then curved north, went to En Shemesh, continued to Geliloth, which faces the Pass of Adummim, and ran down to the Stone of Bohan son of Reuben.
- 18 continued toward the north flank of Beth Arabah, then plunged to the Arabah.
- 18 It continued to the northern slope of Beth Arabah and on down into the Arabah.
- 19 It then followed the slope of Beth Hoglah north and came out at the northern bay of the Salt Sea--the south end of the Jordan. This was the southern border.

- 19 It then went to the northern slope of Beth Hoglah and came out at the northern bay of the Salt Sea, at the mouth of the Jordan in the south. This was the southern boundary.
- 20 The east border was formed by the Jordan. This was the inheritance of the people of Benjamin for their clans, marked by these borders on all sides.
- 20 The Jordan formed the boundary on the eastern side. These were the boundaries that marked out the inheritance of the clans of Benjamin on all sides.
- 21 The cities of the tribe of Benjamin, clan by clan, were: Jericho, Beth Hoglah, Emek Keziz,
- 21 The tribe of Benjamin, clan by clan, had the following cities: Jericho, Beth Hoglah, Emek Keziz,
- 22 Beth Arabah, Zemaraim, Bethel,
- 22 Beth Arabah, Zemaraim, Bethel,
- 23 Avvim, Parah, Ophrah,
- 23 Avvim, Parah, Ophrah,
- 24 Kephlar Ammoni, Ophni, and Geba-- twelve towns with their villages.
- 24 Kephlar Ammoni, Ophni and Geba-- twelve towns and their villages.
- 25 Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth,
- 25 Gibeon, Ramah, Beeroth,
- 26 Mizpah, Kephirah, Mozah,
- 26 Mizpah, Kephirah, Mozah,
- 27 Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah,
- 27 Rekem, Irpeel, Taralah,
- 28 Zelah, Haeleph, the Jebusite city (that is, Jerusalem), Gibeah, and Kiriath Jearim-- fourteen cities with their villages. This was the inheritance for Benjamin, according to its clans.
- 28 Zelah, Haeleph, the Jebusite city (that is, Jerusalem), Gibeah and Kiriath--fourteen towns and their villages. This was the inheritance of Benjamin for its clans.

Joshua 19

MSG

NIV

- 1 The second lot went to Simeon for its clans. Their inheritance was within the territory of Judah.
- 1 The second lot came out for the tribe of Simeon, clan by clan. Their inheritance lay within the territory of Judah.
- 2 In their inheritance they had: Beersheba (or Sheba), Moladah,
- 2 It included: Beersheba (or Sheba), Moladah,
- 3 Hazar Shual, Balah, Ezem,
- 3 Hazar Shual, Balah, Ezem,
- 4 Eltolad, Bethul, Hormah,
- 4 Eltolad, Bethul, Hormah,
- 5 Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susah,
- 5 Ziklag, Beth Marcaboth, Hazar Susah,
- 6 Beth Lebaoth, and Sharuhem-- thirteen towns and their villages.
- 6 Beth Lebaoth and Sharuhem--thirteen towns and their villages;
- 7 Ain, Rimmon, Ether, and Ashan-- four towns and their villages--
- 7 Ain, Rimmon, Ether and Ashan--four towns and their villages--
- 8 plus all the villages around these towns as far as Baalath Beer, the Ramah of the Negev. This is the inheritance of the tribe of Simeon according to its clans.
- 8 and all the villages around these towns as far as Baalath Beer (Ramah in the Negev). This was the inheritance of the tribe of the Simeonites, clan by clan.
- 9 The inheritance of Simeon came out of the share of Judah, because Judah's portion turned out to be more than they needed. That's how the people of Simeon came to get their lot from within Judah's portion.
- 9 The inheritance of the Simeonites was taken from the share of Judah, because Judah's portion was more than they needed. So the Simeonites received their inheritance within the territory of Judah.
- 10 The third lot went to Zebulun, clan by clan: The border of their inheritance went all the way to Sarid.
- 10 The third lot came up for Zebulun, clan by clan: The boundary of their inheritance went as far as Sarid.
- 11 It ran west to Maralah, met Dabbesheth, and then went to the brook opposite Jokneam.
- 11 Going west it ran to Maralah, touched Dabbesheth, and extended to the ravine near Jokneam.

- 12 In the other direction from Sarid, the border ran east; it followed the sunrise to the border of Kisloth Tabor, on to Daberath and up to Japhia.
- 12 It turned east from Sarid toward the sunrise to the territory of Kisloth Tabor and went on to Daberath and up to Japhia.
- 13 It continued east to Gath Hepher and Eth Kazin, came out at Rimmon, and turned toward Neah.
- 13 Then it continued eastward to Gath Hepher and Eth Kazin; it came out at Rimmon and turned toward Neah.
- 14 There the border went around on the north to Hannathon and ran out into the Valley of Iphtah El.
- 14 There the boundary went around on the north to Hannathon and ended at the Valley of Iphtah El.
- 15 It included Kattath, Nahalal, Shimron, Idalah, and Bethlehem--twelve cities with their villages.
- 15 Included were Kattath, Nahalal, Shimron, Idalah and Bethlehem. There were twelve towns and their villages.
- 16 This is the inheritance of the people of Zebulun for their clans--these towns and their villages.
- 16 These towns and their villages were the inheritance of Zebulun, clan by clan.
- 17 The fourth lot went to Issachar, clan by clan.
- 17 The fourth lot came out for Issachar, clan by clan.
- 18 Their territory included: Jezreel, Kesulloth, Shunem,
- 18 Their territory included: Jezreel, Kesulloth, Shunem,
- 19 Hapharaim, Shion, Anaharath,
- 19 Hapharaim, Shion, Anaharath,
- 20 Rabbith, Kishion, Ebez,
- 20 Rabbith, Kishion, Ebez,
- 21 Remeth, En Gannim, En Haddah, and Beth Pazzez.
- 21 Remeth, En Gannim, En Haddah and Beth Pazzez.
- 22 The boundary touched Tabor, Shahazumah, and Beth Shemesh and ended at the Jordan--sixteen towns and their villages.
- 22 The boundary touched Tabor, Shahazumah and Beth Shemesh, and ended at the Jordan. There were sixteen towns and their villages.
- 23 These towns with their villages were the inheritance of the tribe of Issachar, clan by clan.

- 23 These towns and their villages were the inheritance of the tribe of Issachar, clan by clan.
- 24 The fifth lot went to the tribe of Asher, clan by clan:
- 24 The fifth lot came out for the tribe of Asher, clan by clan.
- 25 Their territory included Helkath, Hali, Beten, Acshaph,
- 25 Their territory included: Helkath, Hali, Beten, Acshaph,
- 26 Allammelech, Amad, and Mishal. The western border touched Carmel and Shihor Libnath,
- 26 Allammelech, Amad and Mishal. On the west the boundary touched Carmel and Shihor Libnath.
- 27 then turned east toward Beth Dagon, touched Zebulun and the Valley of Iphtah El, and went north to Beth Emek and Neiel, skirting Cabul on the left.
- 27 It then turned east toward Beth Dagon, touched Zebulun and the Valley of Iphtah El, and went north to Beth Emek and Neiel, passing Cabul on the left.
- 28 It went on to Abdon, Rehob, Hammon, and Kanah, all the way to Greater Sidon.
- 28 It went to Abdon, Rehob, Hammon and Kanah, as far as Greater Sidon.
- 29 The border circled back toward Ramah, extended to the fort city of Tyre, turned toward Hosah, and came out at the Sea in the region of Aczib,
- 29 The boundary then turned back toward Ramah and went to the fortified city of Tyre, turned toward Hosah and came out at the sea in the region of Aczib,
- 30 Ummah, Aphek, and Rehob--twenty-two towns and their villages.
- 30 Ummah, Aphek and Rehob. There were twenty-two towns and their villages.
- 31 These towns and villages were the inheritance of the tribe of Asher, clan by clan.
- 31 These towns and their villages were the inheritance of the tribe of Asher, clan by clan.
- 32 The sixth lot came to Naphtali and its clans.
- 32 The sixth lot came out for Naphtali, clan by clan:
- 33 Their border ran from Heleph, from the oak at Zaanannim, passing Adami Nekeb and Jabneel to Lakkum and ending at the Jordan.

- 33 Their boundary went from Heleph and the large tree in Zaanannim, passing Adami Nekeb and Jabneel to Lakkum and ending at the Jordan.
- 34 The border returned on the west at Aznoth Tabor and came out at Hukkok, meeting Zebulun on the south, Asher on the west, and the Jordan on the east.
- 34 The boundary ran west through Aznoth Tabor and came out at Hukkok. It touched Zebulun on the south, Asher on the west and the Jordan on the east.
- 35 The fort cities were: Ziddim, Zer, Hammath, Rakkath, Kinnereth,
- 35 The fortified cities were Ziddim, Zer, Hammath, Rakkath, Kinnereth,
- 36 Adamah, Ramah, Hazor,
- 36 Adamah, Ramah, Hazor,
- 37 Kedesh, Edrei, En Hazor,
- 37 Kedesh, Edrei, En Hazor,
- 38 Iron, Migdal El, Horem, Beth Anath, and Beth Shemesh-- nineteen towns and their villages.
- 38 Iron, Migdal El, Horem, Beth Anath and Beth Shemesh. There were nineteen towns and their villages.
- 39 This is the inheritance of the tribe of Naphtali, the cities and their villages, clan by clan.
- 39 These towns and their villages were the inheritance of the tribe of Naphtali, clan by clan.
- 40 The seventh lot fell to Dan.
- 40 The seventh lot came out for the tribe of Dan, clan by clan.
- 41 The territory of their inheritance included: Zorah, Eshtaol, Ir Shemesh,
- 41 The territory of their inheritance included: Zorah, Eshtaol, Ir Shemesh,
- 42 Shaalabbin, Aijalon, Ithlah,
- 42 Shaalabbin, Aijalon, Ithlah,
- 43 Elon, Timnah, Ekron,
- 43 Elon, Timnah, Ekron,
- 44 Eltekeh, Gibbethon, Baalath,
- 44 Eltekeh, Gibbethon, Baalath,
- 45 Jehud, Bene Berak, Gath Rimmon,
- 45 Jehud, Bene Berak, Gath Rimmon,
- 46 Me Jarkon, and Rakkon, with the region facing Joppa.
- 46 Me Jarkon and Rakkon, with the area facing Joppa.

- 47 But the people of Dan failed to get rid of the Westerners (Amorites), who pushed them back into the hills. The Westerners kept them out of the plain and they didn't have enough room. So the people of Dan marched up and attacked Leshem. They took it, killed the inhabitants, and settled in. They renamed it Leshem Dan after the name of Dan their ancestor.
- 47 (But the Danites had difficulty taking possession of their territory, so they went up and attacked Leshem, took it, put it to the sword and occupied it. They settled in Leshem and named it Dan after their forefather.)
- 48 This is the inheritance of the tribe of Dan, according to its clans, these towns with their villages.
- 48 These towns and their villages were the inheritance of the tribe of Dan, clan by clan.
- 49 They completed the dividing of the land as inheritance and the setting of its boundaries. The People of Israel then gave an inheritance among them to Joshua son of Nun.
- 49 When they had finished dividing the land into its allotted portions, the Israelites gave Joshua son of Nun an inheritance among them,
- 50 In obedience to GOD's word, they gave him the city which he had requested, Timnath Serah in the hill country of Ephraim. He rebuilt the city and settled there.
- 50 as the LORD had commanded. They gave him the town he asked for-- Timnath Serah in the hill country of Ephraim. And he built up the town and settled there.
- 51 These are the inheritances which Eleazar the priest and Joshua son of Nun and the ancestral leaders assigned by lot to the tribes of Israel at Shiloh in the presence of GOD at the entrance of the Tent of Meeting. They completed the dividing of the land.
- 51 These are the territories that Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun and the heads of the tribal clans of Israel assigned by lot at Shiloh in the presence of the LORD at the entrance to the Tent of Meeting. And so they finished dividing the land.

Joshua 20

MSG

NIV

- 1 Then GOD spoke to Joshua:
- 1 Then the LORD said to Joshua:
- 2 "Tell the People of Israel: Designate the asylum-cities, as I instructed you through Moses,
- 2 Tell the Israelites to designate the cities of refuge, as I instructed you through Moses,
- 3 so that anyone who kills a person accidentally--that is, unintentionally--may flee there as a safe place of asylum from the avenger of blood.
- 3 so that anyone who kills a person accidentally and unintentionally may flee there and find protection from the avenger of blood.
- 4 "A person shall escape for refuge to one of these cities, stand at the entrance to the city gate, and lay out his case before the city's leaders. The leaders must then take him into the city among them and give him a place to live with them.
- 4 When he flees to one of these cities, he is to stand in the entrance of the city gate and state his case before the elders of that city. Then they are to admit him into their city and give him a place to live with them.
- 5 "If the avenger of blood chases after him, they must not give him up--he didn't intend to kill the person; there was no history of ill-feeling.
- 5 If the avenger of blood pursues him, they must not surrender the one accused, because he killed his neighbor unintentionally and without malice aforethought.
- 6 He may stay in that city until he has stood trial before the congregation and until the death of the current high priest. Then he may go back to his own home in his hometown from which he fled."
- 6 He is to stay in that city until he has stood trial before the assembly and until the death of the high priest who is serving at that time. Then he may go back to his own home in the town from which he fled."
- 7 They set apart Kedesh in Galilee in the hills of Naphtali, Shechem in the hills of Ephraim, and Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron) in the hills of Judah.
- 7 So they set apart Kedesh in Galilee in the hill country of Naphtali, Shechem in the hill country of Ephraim, and Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron) in the hill country of Judah.

- 8 On the other side of the Jordan, east of Jericho, they designated Bezer on the desert plateau from the tribe of Reuben, Ramoth in Gilead from the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan from the tribe of Manasseh.
- 8 On the east side of the Jordan of Jericho they designated Bezer in the desert on the plateau in the tribe of Reuben, Ramoth in Gilead in the tribe of Gad, and Golan in Bashan in the tribe of Manasseh.
- 9 These were the designated cities for the People of Israel and any resident foreigner living among them, so that anyone who killed someone unintentionally could flee there and not die by the hand of the avenger of blood without a fair trial before the congregation.
- 9 Any of the Israelites or any alien living among them who killed someone accidentally could flee to these designated cities and not be killed by the avenger of blood prior to standing trial before the assembly.

Joshua 21

MSG

NIV

- 1 The ancestral heads of the Levites came to Eleazar the priest and Joshua son of Nun and to the heads of the other tribes of the People of Israel.
- 1 Now the family heads of the Levites approached Eleazar the priest, Joshua son of Nun, and the heads of the other tribal families of Israel
- 2 This took place at Shiloh in the land of Canaan. They said, "GOD commanded through Moses that you give us cities to live in with access to pastures for our cattle."
- 2 at Shiloh in Canaan and said to them, "The LORD commanded through Moses that you give us towns to live in, with pasturelands for our livestock."
- 3 So the People of Israel, out of their own inheritance, gave the Levites, just as GOD commanded, the following cities and pastures:
- 3 So, as the LORD had commanded, the Israelites gave the Levites the following towns and pasturelands out of their own inheritance:
- 4 The lot came out for the families of the Kohathites this way: Levites descended from Aaron the priest received by lot thirteen cities out of the tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin.

- 4 The first lot came out for the Kohathites, clan by clan. The Levites who were descendants of Aaron the priest were allotted thirteen towns from the tribes of Judah, Simeon and Benjamin.
- 5 The rest of the Kohathites received by lot ten cities from the families of the tribes of Ephraim, Dan, and the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- 5 The rest of Kohath's descendants were allotted ten towns from the clans of the tribes of Ephraim, Dan and half of Manasseh.
- 6 The Gershonites received by lot thirteen cities from the families of the tribes of Issachar, Asher, Naphtali, and the half-tribe of Manasseh in Bashan.
- 6 The descendants of Gershon were allotted thirteen towns from the clans of the tribes of Issachar, Asher, Naphtali and the half-tribe of Manasseh in Bashan.
- 7 The families of the Merarites received twelve towns from the tribes of Reuben, Gad, and Zebulun.
- 7 The descendants of Merari, clan by clan, received twelve towns from the tribes of Reuben, Gad and Zebulun.
- 8 So the People of Israel gave these cities with their pastures to the Levites just as GOD had ordered through Moses, that is, by lot.
- 8 So the Israelites allotted to the Levites these towns and their pasturelands, as the LORD had commanded through Moses.
- 9 They assigned from the tribes of Judah, Simeon, and Benjamin the following towns, here named individually
- 9 From the tribes of Judah and Simeon they allotted the following towns by name
- 10 (these were for the descendants of Aaron who were from the families of the Kohathite branch of Levi because the first lot fell to them):
- 10 (these towns were assigned to the descendants of Aaron who were from the Kohathite clans of the Levites, because the first lot fell to them):
- 11 Kiriath Arba (Arba was the ancestor of Anak), that is, Hebron, in the hills of Judah, with access to the pastures around it.
- 11 They gave them Kiriath Arba (that is, Hebron), with its surrounding pastureland, in the hill country of Judah. (Arba was the forefather of Anak.)
- 12 The fields of the city and its open lands they had already given to Caleb son of Jephunneh as his possession.

- 12 But the fields and villages around the city they had given to Caleb son of Jephunneh as his possession.
- 13 To the descendants of Aaron the priest they gave Hebron (the asylum-city for the unconvicted killers), Libnah,
- 13 So to the descendants of Aaron the priest they gave Hebron (a city of refuge for one accused of murder), Libnah,
- 14 Jattir, Eshtemoa,
- 14 Jattir, Eshtemoa,
- 15 Holon, Debir,
- 15 Holon, Debir,
- 16 Ain, Juttah, and Beth Shemesh, all with their accompanying pastures--nine towns from these two tribes.
- 16 Ain, Juttah and Beth Shemesh, together with their pasturelands--nine towns from these two tribes.
- 17 And from the tribe of Benjamin: Gibeon, Geba,
- 17 And from the tribe of Benjamin they gave them Gibeon, Geba,
- 18 Anathoth, and Almon, together with their pastures--four towns.
- 18 Anathoth and Almon, together with their pasturelands--four towns.
- 19 The total for the cities and pastures for the priests descended from Aaron came to thirteen.
- 19 All the towns for the priests, the descendants of Aaron, were thirteen, together with their pasturelands.
- 20 The rest of the Kohathite families from the tribe of Levi were assigned their cities by lot from the tribe of Ephraim:
- 20 The rest of the Kohathite clans of the Levites were allotted towns from the tribe of Ephraim:
- 21 Shechem (the asylum-city for the unconvicted killer) in the hills of Ephraim, Gezer,
- 21 In the hill country of Ephraim they were given Shechem (a city of refuge for one accused of murder) and Gezer,
- 22 Kibzaim, and Beth Horon, with their pastures--four towns.
- 22 Kibzaim and Beth Horon, together with their pasturelands--four towns.
- 23 From the tribe of Dan they received Eltekeh, Gibbethon,
- 23 Also from the tribe of Dan they received Eltekeh, Gibbethon,
- 24 Aijalon, and Gath Rimmon, all with their pastures--four towns.
- 24 Aijalon and Gath Rimmon, together with their pasturelands--four towns.

- 25 And from the half-tribe of Manasseh they received Taanach and Gath Rimmon with their pastures--two towns.
- 25 From half the tribe of Manasseh they received Taanach and Gath Rimmon, together with their pasturelands--two towns.
- 26 All told, ten cities with their pastures went to the remaining Kohathite families.
- 26 All these ten towns and their pasturelands were given to the rest of the Kohathite clans.
- 27 The Gershonite families of the tribe of Levi were given from the half-tribe of Manasseh: Golan in Bashan (an asylum-city for the unconvicted killer), and Be Eshtarah, with their pastures--two cities.
- 27 The Levite clans of the Gershonites were given: from the half-tribe of Manasseh, Golan in Bashan (a city of refuge for one accused of murder) and Be Eshtarah, together with their pasturelands--two towns;
- 28 And from the tribe of Issachar: Kishion, Daberath,
- 28 from the tribe of Issachar, Kishion, Daberath,
- 29 Jarmuth, and En Gannim, with their pastures--four towns.
- 29 Jarmuth and En Gannim, together with their pasturelands--four towns;
- 30 From the tribe of Asher: Mishal, Abdon,
- 30 from the tribe of Asher, Mishal, Abdon,
- 31 Helkath, and Rehob, with their pastures--four towns.
- 31 Helkath and Rehob, together with their pasturelands--four towns;
- 32 From the tribe of Naphtali: Kedesh in Galilee (an asylum-city for the unconvicted killer), Hammoth Dor, and Kartan, with their pastures--three towns.
- 32 from the tribe of Naphtali, Kedesh in Galilee (a city of refuge for one accused of murder), Hammoth Dor and Kartan, together with their pasturelands--three towns.
- 33 For the Gershonites and their families: thirteen towns with their pastures.
- 33 All the towns of the Gershonite clans were thirteen, together with their pasturelands.
- 34 The Merari families, the remaining Levites, were given from the tribe of Zebulun: Jokneam, Kartah,
- 34 The Merarite clans (the rest of the Levites) were given: from the tribe of Zebulun, Jokneam, Kartah,

35 Dimnah, and Nahalal, with their pastures--four cities.
35 Dimnah and Nahalal, together with their pasturelands--four towns;
36 From the tribe of Reuben: Bezer, Jahaz,
36 from the tribe of Reuben, Bezer, Jahaz,
37 Kedemoth, and Mephaath, with their pastures--four towns.
37 Kedemoth and Mephaath, together with their pasturelands--four towns;
38 From the tribe of Gad: Ramoth in Gilead (an asylum-city for the
unconvicted killer), Mahanaim,
38 from the tribe of Gad, Ramoth in Gilead (a city of refuge for one
accused of murder), Mahanaim,
39 Heshbon, and Jazer, with their pastures--a total of four towns.
39 Heshbon and Jazer, together with their pasturelands-- four towns in all.
40 All these towns were assigned by lot to the Merarites, the remaining
Levites--twelve towns.
40 All the towns allotted to the Merarite clans, who were the rest of the
Levites, were twelve.
41 The Levites held forty-eight towns with their accompanying pastures
within the territory of the People of Israel.
41 The towns of the Levites in the territory held by the Israelites were
forty-eight in all, together with their pasturelands.
42 Each of these towns had pastures surrounding it--this was the case for
all these towns.
42 Each of these towns had pasturelands surrounding it; this was true for
all these towns.
43 And so GOD gave Israel the entire land that he had solemnly vowed to
give to their ancestors. They took possession of it and made themselves
at home in it.
43 So the LORD gave Israel all the land he had sworn to give their
forefathers, and they took possession of it and settled there.
44 And GOD gave them rest on all sides, as he had also solemnly vowed to
their ancestors. Not a single one of their enemies was able to stand up to
them--GOD handed over all their enemies to them.
44 The LORD gave them rest on every side, just as he had sworn to their
forefathers. Not one of their enemies withstood them; the LORD handed
all their enemies over to them.

45 Not one word failed from all the good words GOD spoke to the house of Israel. Everything came out right.

45 Not one of all the LORD's good promises to the house of Israel failed; every one was fulfilled.

Joshua 22

MSG

NIV

1 Then Joshua called together the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh.

1 Then Joshua summoned the Reubenites, the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh

2 He said: "You have carried out everything Moses the servant of GOD commanded you, and you have obediently done everything I have commanded you.

2 and said to them, "You have done all that Moses the servant of the LORD commanded, and you have obeyed me in everything I commanded.

3 All this time and right down to this very day you have not abandoned your brothers; you've shouldered the task laid on you by GOD, your God.

3 For a long time now--to this very day--you have not deserted your brothers but have carried out the mission the LORD your God gave you.

4 And now GOD, your God, has given rest to your brothers just as he promised them. You're now free to go back to your homes, the country of your inheritance that Moses the servant of GOD gave you on the other side of the Jordan.

4 Now that the LORD your God has given your brothers rest as he promised, return to your homes in the land that Moses the servant of the LORD gave you on the other side of the Jordan.

5 Only this: Be vigilant in keeping the Commandment and The Revelation that Moses the servant of GOD laid on you: Love GOD, your God, walk in all his ways, do what he's commanded, embrace him, serve him with everything you are and have."

5 But be very careful to keep the commandment and the law that Moses the servant of the LORD gave you: to love the LORD your God, to walk in

- all his ways, to obey his commands, to hold fast to him and to serve him with all your heart and all your soul."
- 6 Then Joshua blessed them and sent them on their way. They went home.
- 6 Then Joshua blessed them and sent them away, and they went to their homes.
- 7 (To the half-tribe of Manasseh, Moses had assigned a share in Bashan. To the other half, Joshua assigned land with their brothers west of the Jordan.) When Joshua sent them off to their homes, he blessed them.
- 7 (To the half-tribe of Manasseh Moses had given land in Bashan, and to the other half of the tribe Joshua gave land on the west side of the Jordan with their brothers.) When Joshua sent them home, he blessed them,
- 8 He said: "Go home. You're going home rich--great herds of cattle, silver and gold, bronze and iron, huge piles of clothing. Share the wealth with your friends and families--all this plunder from your enemies!"
- 8 saying, "Return to your homes with your great wealth--with large herds of livestock, with silver, gold, bronze and iron, and a great quantity of clothing--and divide with your brothers the plunder from your enemies."
- 9 The Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh left the People of Israel at Shiloh in the land of Canaan to return to Gilead, the land of their possession, which they had taken under the command of Moses as ordered by GOD.
- 9 So the Reubenites, the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh left the Israelites at Shiloh in Canaan to return to Gilead, their own land, which they had acquired in accordance with the command of the LORD through Moses.
- 10 They arrived at Geliloth on the Jordan (touching on Canaanite land). There the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh built an altar on the banks of the Jordan--a huge altar!
- 10 When they came to Geliloth near the Jordan in the land of Canaan, the Reubenites, the Gadites and the half-tribe of Manasseh built an imposing altar there by the Jordan.
- 11 The People of Israel heard of it: "What's this? The Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh have built an altar facing the land of Canaan at Geliloth on the Jordan, across from the People of Israel!"
- 11 And when the Israelites heard that they had built the altar on the border of Canaan at Geliloth near the Jordan on the Israelite side,

- 12 When the People of Israel heard this, the entire congregation mustered at Shiloh to go to war against them.
- 12 the whole assembly of Israel gathered at Shiloh to go to war against them.
- 13 They sent Phinehas son of Eleazar the priest to the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh (that is, to the land of Gilead).
- 13 So the Israelites sent Phinehas son of Eleazar, the priest, to the land of Gilead--to Reuben, Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh.
- 14 Accompanying him were ten chiefs, one chief for each of the ten tribes, each the head of his ancestral family. They represented the military divisions of Israel.
- 14 With him they sent ten of the chief men, one for each of the tribes of Israel, each the head of a family division among the Israelite clans.
- 15 They went to the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh and spoke to them:
- 15 When they went to Gilead--to Reuben, Gad and the half- tribe of Manasseh--they said to them:
- 16 "The entire congregation of GOD wants to know: What is this violation against the God of Israel that you have committed, turning your back on GOD and building your own altar--a blatant act of rebellion against GOD?
- 16 The whole assembly of the LORD says: 'How could you break faith with the God of Israel like this? How could you turn away from the LORD and build yourselves an altar in rebellion against him now?
- 17 Wasn't the crime of Peor enough for us? Why, to this day we aren't rid of it, still living with the fallout of the plague on the congregation of GOD!
- 17 Was not the sin of Peor enough for us? Up to this very day we have not cleansed ourselves from that sin, even though a plague fell on the community of the LORD!
- 18 Look at you--turning your back on GOD! If you rebel against GOD today, tomorrow he'll vent his anger on all of us, the entire congregation of Israel.
- 18 And are you now turning away from the LORD? " 'If you rebel against the LORD today, tomorrow he will be angry with the whole community of Israel.

- 19 "If you think the land of your possession isn't holy enough but somehow contaminated, come back over to GOD's possession, where GOD's Dwelling is set up, and take your land there, but don't rebel against GOD. And don't rebel against us by building your own altar apart from the Altar of our GOD.
- 19 If the land you possess is defiled, come over to the LORD's land, where the LORD's tabernacle stands, and share the land with us. But do not rebel against the LORD or against us by building an altar for yourselves, other than the altar of the LORD our God.
- 20 When Achan son of Zerah violated the holy curse, didn't anger fall on the whole congregation of Israel? He wasn't the only one to die for his sin."
- 20 When Achan son of Zerah acted unfaithfully regarding the devoted things, did not wrath come upon the whole community of Israel? He was not the only one who died for his sin.' "
- 21 The Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh replied to the heads of the tribes of Israel:
- 21 Then Reuben, Gad and the half-tribe of Manasseh replied to the heads of the clans of Israel:
- 22 The God of Gods is GOD, The God of Gods is GOD! "He knows and he'll let Israel know if this is a rebellious betrayal of GOD. And if it is, don't bother saving us.
- 22 The Mighty One, God, the LORD! The Mighty One, God, the LORD! He knows! And let Israel know! If this has been in rebellion or disobedience to the LORD, do not spare us this day.
- 23 If we built ourselves an altar in rebellion against GOD, if we did it to present on it Whole-Burnt-Offerings or Grain-Offerings or to enact there sacrificial Peace-Offerings, let GOD decide.
- 23 If we have built our own altar to turn away from the LORD and to offer burnt offerings and grain offerings, or to sacrifice fellowship offerings on it, may the LORD himself call us to account.
- 24 "But that's not it. We did it because we cared. We were anxious lest someday your children should say to our children, 'You're not connected with GOD, the God of Israel!
- 24 No! We did it for fear that some day your descendants might say to ours, 'What do you have to do with the LORD, the God of Israel?

- 25 GOD made the Jordan a boundary between us and you. You Reubenites and Gadites have no part in GOD.' And then your children might cause our children to quit worshiping GOD.
- 25 The LORD has made the Jordan a boundary between us and you--you Reubenites and Gadites! You have no share in the LORD.' So your descendants might cause ours to stop fearing the LORD.
- 26 "So we said to ourselves, 'Let's do something. Let's build an altar--but not for Whole-Burnt-Offerings, not for sacrifices.'
- 26 That is why we said, 'Let us get ready and build an altar--but not for burnt offerings or sacrifices.'
- 27 "We built this altar as a witness between us and you and our children coming after us, a witness to the Altar where we worship GOD in his Sacred Dwelling with our Whole-Burnt-Offerings and our sacrifices and our Peace-Offerings. "This way, your children won't be able to say to our children in the future, 'You have no part in GOD.'
- 27 On the contrary, it is to be a witness between us and you and the generations that follow, that we will worship the LORD at his sanctuary with our burnt offerings, sacrifices and fellowship offerings. Then in the future your descendants will not be able to say to ours, 'You have no share in the LORD.'
- 28 "We said to ourselves, 'If anyone speaks disparagingly to us or to our children in the future, we'll say: Look at this model of GOD's Altar which our ancestors made. It's not for Whole-Burnt-Offerings, not for sacrifices. It's a witness connecting us with you.'
- 28 And we said, 'If they ever say this to us, or to our descendants, we will answer: Look at the replica of the LORD's altar, which our fathers built, not for burnt offerings and sacrifices, but as a witness between us and you.'
- 29 "Rebelling against or turning our backs on GOD is the last thing on our minds right now. We never dreamed of building an altar for Whole-Burnt-Offerings or Grain-Offerings to rival the Altar of our GOD in front of his Sacred Dwelling."
- 29 Far be it from us to rebel against the LORD and turn away from him today by building an altar for burnt offerings, grain offerings and sacrifices, other than the altar of the LORD our God that stands before his tabernacle.

- 30 Phinehas the priest, all the heads of the congregation, and the heads of the military divisions of Israel who were also with him heard what the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh had to say. They were satisfied.
- 30 When Phinehas the priest and the leaders of the community--the heads of the clans of the Israelites--heard what Reuben, Gad and Manasseh had to say, they were pleased.
- 31 Priest Phinehas son of Eleazar said to Reuben, Gad, and Manasseh, "Now we're convinced that GOD is present with us since you haven't been disloyal to GOD in this matter. You saved the People of Israel from GOD's discipline."
- 31 And Phinehas son of Eleazar, the priest, said to Reuben, Gad and Manasseh, "Today we know that the LORD is with us, because you have not acted unfaithfully toward the LORD in this matter. Now you have rescued the Israelites from the LORD's hand."
- 32 Then Priest Phinehas son of Eleazar left the Reubenites, Gadites, and the half-tribe of Manasseh (from Gilead) and, with the chiefs, returned to the land of Canaan to the People of Israel and gave a full report.
- 32 Then Phinehas son of Eleazar, the priest, and the leaders returned to Canaan from their meeting with the Reubenites and Gadites in Gilead and reported to the Israelites.
- 33 They were pleased with the report. The People of Israel blessed God--there was no more talk of attacking and destroying the land in which the Reubenites and Gadites were living.
- 33 They were glad to hear the report and praised God. And they talked no more about going to war against them to devastate the country where the Reubenites and the Gadites lived.
- 34 Reuben and Gad named the altar: A Witness Between Us. GOD Alone Is God.
- 34 And the Reubenites and the Gadites gave the altar this name: A Witness Between Us that the LORD is God.

Joshua 23

MSG

NIV

- 1 A long time later, after GOD had given Israel rest from all their surrounding enemies, and Joshua was a venerable old man,
- 1 After a long time had passed and the LORD had given Israel rest from all their enemies around them, Joshua, by then old and well advanced in years,
- 2 Joshua called all Israel together--elders, chiefs, judges, and officers. Then he spoke to them: "I'm an old man. I've lived a long time.
- 2 summoned all Israel--their elders, leaders, judges and officials--and said to them: "I am old and well advanced in years.
- 3 You have seen everything that GOD has done to these nations because of you. He did it because he's GOD, your God. He fought for you.
- 3 You yourselves have seen everything the LORD your God has done to all these nations for your sake; it was the LORD your God who fought for you.
- 4 "Stay alert: I have assigned to you by lot these nations that remain as an inheritance to your tribes--these in addition to the nations I have already cut down--from the Jordan to the Great Sea in the west.
- 4 Remember how I have allotted as an inheritance for your tribes all the land of the nations that remain--the nations I conquered--between the Jordan and the Great Sea in the west.
- 5 GOD, your God, will drive them out of your path until there's nothing left of them and you'll take over their land just as GOD, your God, promised you.
- 5 The LORD your God himself will drive them out of your way. He will push them out before you, and you will take possession of their land, as the LORD your God promised you.
- 6 "Now, stay strong and steady. Obediently do everything written in the Book of The Revelation of Moses--don't miss a detail.
- 6 Be very strong; be careful to obey all that is written in the Book of the Law of Moses, without turning aside to the right or to the left.
- 7 Don't get mixed up with the nations that are still around. Don't so much as speak the names of their gods or swear by them. And by all means don't worship or pray to them.
- 7 Do not associate with these nations that remain among you; do not invoke the names of their gods or swear by them. You must not serve them or bow down to them.

- 8 Hold tight to GOD, your God, just as you've done up to now.
- 8 But you are to hold fast to the LORD your God, as you have until now.
- 9 "GOD has driven out superpower nations before you. And up to now, no one has been able to stand up to you.
- 9 The LORD has driven out before you great and powerful nations; to this day no one has been able to withstand you.
- 10 Think of it--one of you, single-handedly, putting a thousand on the run! Because GOD is GOD, your God. Because he fights for you, just as he promised you.
- 10 One of you routs a thousand, because the LORD your God fights for you, just as he promised.
- 11 "Now, vigilantly guard your souls: Love GOD, your God.
- 11 So be very careful to love the LORD your God.
- 12 Because if you wander off and start taking up with these remaining nations still among you (intermarry, say, and have other dealings with them),
- 12 But if you turn away and ally yourselves with the survivors of these nations that remain among you and if you intermarry with them and associate with them,
- 13 know for certain that GOD, your God, will not get rid of these nations for you. They'll be nothing but trouble to you--horsewhips on your backs and sand in your eyes--until you're the ones who will be driven out of this good land that GOD, your God, has given you.
- 13 then you may be sure that the LORD your God will no longer drive out these nations before you. Instead, they will become snares and traps for you, whips on your backs and thorns in your eyes, until you perish from this good land, which the LORD your God has given you.
- 14 "As you can see, I'm about to go the way we all end up going. Know this with all your heart, with everything in you, that not one detail has failed of all the good things GOD, your God, promised you. It has all happened. Nothing's left undone--not so much as a word.
- 14 Now I am about to go the way of all the earth. You know with all your heart and soul that not one of all the good promises the LORD your God gave you has failed. Every promise has been fulfilled; not one has failed.
- 15 "But just as sure as everything good that GOD, your God, has promised has come true, so also GOD will bring to pass every bad thing until

- there's nothing left of you in this good land that GOD has given you.
- 15 But just as every good promise of the LORD your God has come true, so the LORD will bring on you all the evil he has threatened, until he has destroyed you from this good land he has given you.
- 16 If you leave the path of the Covenant of GOD, your God, that he commanded you, go off and serve and worship other gods, GOD's anger will blaze out against you. In no time at all there'll be nothing left of you, no sign that you've ever been in this good land he gave you."
- 16 If you violate the covenant of the LORD your God, which he commanded you, and go and serve other gods and bow down to them, the LORD's anger will burn against you, and you will quickly perish from the good land he has given you."

Joshua 24

MSG

NIV

- 1 Joshua called together all the tribes of Israel at Shechem. He called in the elders, chiefs, judges, and officers. They presented themselves before God.
- 1 Then Joshua assembled all the tribes of Israel at Shechem. He summoned the elders, leaders, judges and officials of Israel, and they presented themselves before God.
- 2 Then Joshua addressed all the people: "This is what GOD, the God of Israel, says: A long time ago your ancestors, Terah and his sons Abraham and Nahor, lived to the east of the River Euphrates. They worshiped other gods.
- 2 Joshua said to all the people, "This is what the LORD, the God of Israel, says: 'Long ago your forefathers, including Terah the father of Abraham and Nahor, lived beyond the River and worshiped other gods.
- 3 I took your ancestor Abraham from the far side of The River. I led him all over the land of Canaan and multiplied his descendants. I gave him Isaac.
- 3 But I took your father Abraham from the land beyond the River and led him throughout Canaan and gave him many descendants. I gave him Isaac,

- 4 Then I gave Isaac Jacob and Esau. I let Esau have the mountains of Seir as home, but Jacob and his sons ended up in Egypt.
- 4 and to Isaac I gave Jacob and Esau. I assigned the hill country of Seir to Esau, but Jacob and his sons went down to Egypt.
- 5 I sent Moses and Aaron. I hit Egypt hard with plagues and then led you out of there.
- 5 'Then I sent Moses and Aaron, and I afflicted the Egyptians by what I did there, and I brought you out.
- 6 I brought your ancestors out of Egypt. You came to the sea, the Egyptians in hot pursuit with chariots and cavalry, to the very edge of the Red Sea!
- 6 When I brought your fathers out of Egypt, you came to the sea, and the Egyptians pursued them with chariots and horsemen as far as the Red Sea.
- 7 "Then they cried out for help to GOD. He put a cloud between you and the Egyptians and then let the sea loose on them. It drowned them. "You watched the whole thing with your own eyes, what I did to Egypt. And then you lived in the wilderness for a long time.
- 7 But they cried to the LORD for help, and he put darkness between you and the Egyptians; he brought the sea over them and covered them. You saw with your own eyes what I did to the Egyptians. Then you lived in the desert for a long time.
- 8 I brought you to the country of the Amorites, who lived east of the Jordan, and they fought you. But I fought for you and you took their land. I destroyed them for you.
- 8 'I brought you to the land of the Amorites who lived east of the Jordan. They fought against you, but I gave them into your hands. I destroyed them from before you, and you took possession of their land.
- 9 Then Balak son of Zippor made his appearance. He was the king of Moab. He got ready to fight Israel by sending for Balaam son of Beor to come and curse you.
- 9 When Balak son of Zippor, the king of Moab, prepared to fight against Israel, he sent for Balaam son of Beor to put a curse on you.
- 10 But I wouldn't listen to Balaam--he ended up blessing you over and over! I saved you from him.
- 10 But I would not listen to Balaam, so he blessed you again and again, and I delivered you out of his hand.

- 11 "You then crossed the Jordan and came to Jericho. The Jericho leaders ganged up on you as well as the Amorites, Perizzites, Canaanites, Hittites, Girgashites, Hivites, and Jebusites, but I turned them over to you.
- 11 'Then you crossed the Jordan and came to Jericho. The citizens of Jericho fought against you, as did also the Amorites, Perizzites, Canaanites, Hittites, Girgashites, Hivites and Jebusites, but I gave them into your hands.
- 12 "I sent the Hornet ahead of you. It drove out the two Amorite kings--did your work for you. You didn't have to do a thing, not so much as raise a finger.
- 12 I sent the hornet ahead of you, which drove them out before you--also the two Amorite kings. You did not do it with your own sword and bow.
- 13 "I handed you a land for which you did not work, towns you did not build. And here you are now living in them and eating from vineyards and olive groves you did not plant.
- 13 So I gave you a land on which you did not toil and cities you did not build; and you live in them and eat from vineyards and olive groves that you did not plant.'
- 14 "So now: Fear GOD. Worship him in total commitment. Get rid of the gods your ancestors worshiped on the far side of The River (the Euphrates) and in Egypt. You, worship GOD.
- 14 Now fear the LORD and serve him with all faithfulness. Throw away the gods your forefathers worshiped beyond the River and in Egypt, and serve the LORD.
- 15 "If you decide that it's a bad thing to worship GOD, then choose a god you'd rather serve--and do it today. Choose one of the gods your ancestors worshiped from the country beyond The River, or one of the gods of the Amorites, on whose land you're now living. As for me and my family, we'll worship GOD."
- 15 But if serving the LORD seems undesirable to you, then choose for yourselves this day whom you will serve, whether the gods your forefathers served beyond the River, or the gods of the Amorites, in whose land you are living. But as for me and my household, we will serve the LORD."

- 16 The people answered, "We'd never forsake GOD! Never! We'd never leave GOD to worship other gods.
- 16 Then the people answered, "Far be it from us to forsake the LORD to serve other gods!
- 17 "GOD is our God! He brought up our ancestors from Egypt and from slave conditions. He did all those great signs while we watched. He has kept his eye on us all along the roads we've traveled and among the nations we've passed through.
- 17 It was the LORD our God himself who brought us and our fathers up out of Egypt, from that land of slavery, and performed those great signs before our eyes. He protected us on our entire journey and among all the nations through which we traveled.
- 18 Just for us he drove out all the nations, Amorites and all, who lived in the land. "Count us in: We too are going to worship GOD. He's our God."
- 18 And the LORD drove out before us all the nations, including the Amorites, who lived in the land. We too will serve the LORD, because he is our God."
- 19 Then Joshua told the people: "You can't do it; you're not able to worship GOD. He is a holy God. He is a jealous God. He won't put up with your fooling around and sinning.
- 19 Joshua said to the people, "You are not able to serve the LORD. He is a holy God; he is a jealous God. He will not forgive your rebellion and your sins.
- 20 When you leave GOD and take up the worship of foreign gods, he'll turn right around and come down on you hard. He'll put an end to you--and after all the good he has done for you!"
- 20 If you forsake the LORD and serve foreign gods, he will turn and bring disaster on you and make an end of you, after he has been good to you."
- 21 But the people told Joshua: "No! No! We worship GOD!"
- 21 But the people said to Joshua, "No! We will serve the LORD."
- 22 And so Joshua addressed the people: "You are witnesses against yourselves that you have chosen GOD for yourselves--to worship him." And they said, "We are witnesses."
- 22 Then Joshua said, "You are witnesses against yourselves that you have chosen to serve the LORD." "Yes, we are witnesses," they replied.

- 23 Joshua said, "Now get rid of all the foreign gods you have with you. Say an unqualified Yes to GOD, the God of Israel."
- 23 Now then, said Joshua, "throw away the foreign gods that are among you and yield your hearts to the LORD, the God of Israel."
- 24 The people answered Joshua, "We will worship GOD. What he says, we'll do."
- 24 And the people said to Joshua, "We will serve the LORD our God and obey him."
- 25 Joshua completed a Covenant for the people that day there at Shechem. He made it official, spelling it out in detail.
- 25 On that day Joshua made a covenant for the people, and there at Shechem he drew up for them decrees and laws.
- 26 Joshua wrote out all the directions and regulations into the Book of The Revelation of God. Then he took a large stone and set it up under the oak that was in the holy place of GOD.
- 26 And Joshua recorded these things in the Book of the Law of God. Then he took a large stone and set it up there under the oak near the holy place of the LORD.
- 27 Joshua spoke to all the people: "This stone is a witness against us. It has heard every word that GOD has said to us. It is a standing witness against you lest you cheat on your God."
- 27 See! he said to all the people. "This stone will be a witness against us. It has heard all the words the LORD has said to us. It will be a witness against you if you are untrue to your God."
- 28 Then Joshua dismissed the people, each to his own place of inheritance.
- 28 Then Joshua sent the people away, each to his own inheritance.
- 29 After all this, Joshua son of Nun, the servant of GOD, died. He was 110 years old.
- 29 After these things, Joshua son of Nun, the servant of the LORD, died at the age of a hundred and ten.
- 30 They buried him in the land of his inheritance at Timnath Serah in the mountains of Ephraim, north of Mount Gaash.
- 30 And they buried him in the land of his inheritance, at Timnath Serah in the hill country of Ephraim, north of Mount Gaash.
- 31 Israel served GOD through the lifetime of Joshua and of the elders who outlived him, who had themselves experienced all that GOD had done

for Israel.

31 Israel served the LORD throughout the lifetime of Joshua and of the elders who outlived him and who had experienced everything the LORD had done for Israel.

32 Joseph's bones, which the People of Israel had brought from Egypt, they buried in Shechem in the plot of ground that Jacob had purchased from the sons of Hamor (who was the father of Shechem). He paid a hundred silver coins for it. It belongs to the inheritance of the family of Joseph.

32 And Joseph's bones, which the Israelites had brought up from Egypt, were buried at Shechem in the tract of land that Jacob bought for a hundred pieces of silver from the sons of Hamor, the father of Shechem. This became the inheritance of Joseph's descendants.

33 Eleazar son of Aaron died. They buried him at Gibeah, which had been allotted to his son Phinehas in the mountains of Ephraim.

33 And Eleazar son of Aaron died and was buried at Gibeah, which had been allotted to his son Phinehas in the hill country of Ephraim.